SATASHKENT

English Elite Book



Real SAT English Hard Questions

2025–2026

YNWA · BGSA

You will never walk alone....!

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DIRECTIONS

Among the small magazines animating Boston's vibrant literary scene in the early twentieth century was _____ by William Stanley Braithwaite and featuring poetry by John Gould Fletcher, Louis Untermeyer, and Richard Aldington; essays by Amy Lowell and Jeanette Marks; and reviews of recent books, this magazine publicized the work of influential avant-garde writers and artists of the day.

1

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. the Poetry Review of America. Edited

B. the Poetry Review of America; edited

C. the Poetry Review of America, edited

D. the Poetry Review of America edited

Text 1

In 1979 Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky presented college students and faculty from Israel, Sweden, and the United States with hypothetical questions involving financial decisions. The finding that a loss is felt more keenly than is a gain of the same value led the researchers to formulate the concept of loss aversion, which has since informed research in fields ranging from behavioral economics to medicine.

Text 2

To test the finding of Kahneman and Tversky's 1979 study, Kai Ruggeri et al. asked participants (some college educated, some not) from Australia, Slovenia, and seventeen other countries the same questions as the ones used in the 1979 study. Ruggeri et al. concluded that although replication rates (how well research findings reproduce across contexts) varied somewhat between countries the rate was 100% in Australia and 85% in Slovenia the average replication rate was an impressive 92%.

2

Based on the texts, how would Ruggeri et al. (Text 2) most likely respond to Kahneman and Tversky's finding (Text 1)?

A. By arguing that the attitude toward financial losses and gains that Kahneman and Tversky observed varies widely within the populations of individual countries.

B. By agreeing that experimental results support the idea that people tend to be more sensitive to financial losses than to gains.

C. By suggesting that, on average, people's expectations about the feasibility of achieving financial gains have changed little since 1979.

D. By asserting that people in Australia and Slovenia are more concerned about financial losses than people in Israel, Sweden, and the United States are.

Carcinization, or the evolution of a crablike body form, has taken place in crustaceans many times over the last 250 million years. Decarcinization has occurred several times as well, even though it involves the loss of traits such as sideways walking that seem to have helped carcinized groups persist in a variety of ecosystems. In a 2021 paper, Joanna Wolfe and team note that many decarcinized groups are extinct and have very few living relatives-signs that decarcinization might be an "evolutionary dead-end." But the team also discusses frog crabs, a living decarcinized group with traits suited to dwelling in sediment; fossils show that the group had decarcinized members as far back as the Early Cretaceous. This example suggests that _____.

3

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. the evolutionary benefits of a crablike body form are less certain than many studies of carcinization had previously implied.

B. despite having many living relatives, some decarcinized groups did not benefit from decarcinization.

C. sideways walking may have been less important to the survival of frog crabs than a protected abdomen and other traits associated with carcinization.

D. a crablike body form may not be optimal in all cases, with ecological conditions sometimes favoring the persistence of decarcinization.

In 19th-century Bengal, cowry shells were used as a commodity currency. By using specific goods like cowry shells as common units of exchange, commodity currency economies streamline trade, which is why they often replaced barter economies. Barter economies eschew _____ that requires what economist W.S. Jevons deems a "double coincidence of wants"-in other words, each trading party must want precisely what the other has.

4

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. currency, in favor of a direct trade system

B. currency-in favor of a direct trade system

C. currency in favor of a direct trade system

D. currency, in favor of a direct trade system,

The following text is from Alice Wong's 2022 memoir Year of the Tiger: An Activist's Life. Wong has just described her tendency to procrastinate when she has a writing deadline.

In the middle of these distractions, a vibe will emerge, a point I want to make, a phrase, a hook, a title for a story, an image. A connection or epiphany can happen while watching or reading something brilliant. By doing "nothing" and daydreaming, I am actually composing, even if words don't immediately materialize.

5

Based on the text, what does Wong most likely mean when she states that she is "composing"?

A. She is deceiving herself about her true feelings about a subject.

B. She is engaging in an important part of her writing process.

C. She is gathering sources of information to use in her writing.

D. She is being soothed by immersing herself in creative works by other people.

Some researchers posit that the species inhabiting the South Pacific island of Grande Terre belong to clades that predate the island's split from remnants of the former supercontinent Gondwana around 80 million years ago. A study conducted by Michael A. Sundue et al. found, however, that the crown age (the age of the most recent common ancestor of all living and extinct species in the clade) of the clade of Grammitis ferns on Grande Terre is 8.5 million years; Sundue et al. further found that the crown age of the clade of Grammitis ferns in the South Pacific generally is approximately 10.0 million years.

6

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It presents a possibility that some researchers have raised, then describes a study that clarifies their reasons for doing so.

B. It explains a view some researchers have advanced, then discusses study results that led them to reconsider that view.

C. It identifies a discrepancy between a hypothesis some researchers have proposed and related research findings, then explains that discrepancy.

D. It describes an idea that some researchers have put forward, then presents study results that are incompatible with that idea.

Some ethicists challenge the concept of personal character, claiming that if it were meaningful, situational factors could not, as they clearly can, induce behavior contrary to that character. As Rachana Kamtekar observes, this argument is difficult to reconcile with our lay conception of character: we expect a person of helpful character to be frequently helpful, not _____ helpful.

7

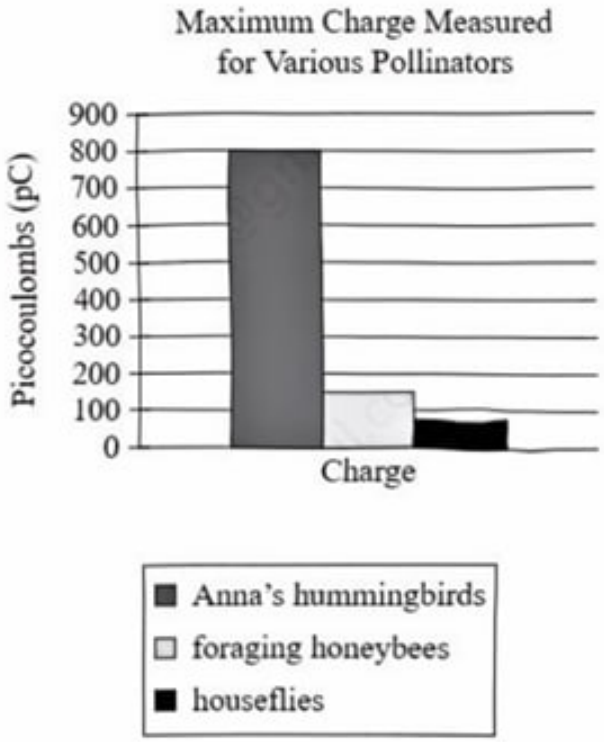
Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. self-servingly

B. unfailingly

C. grudgingly

D. sporadically



Terrestrial plants typically carry a negative electrical charge, while hummingbirds and other pollinators tend to accumulate a positive charge. A team of researchers therefore hypothesized that electrostatic attraction (mutual attraction between objects with opposite charges) might enhance pollen transmission between plants and their pollinator species. The team's experiments showed that the maximum positive charge of foraging honeybees is sufficiently high to facilitate electrostatic pollen transfer, a finding that suggests that _____.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

A. houseflies should demonstrate the opposite tendency.

B. Anna's hummingbirds should also demonstrate this capacity.

C. the minimum positive charge necessary for a pollinator to induce electrostatic attraction must be greater than 100 pC.

D. Anna's hummingbirds and houseflies, having greater maximum charges than foraging honeybees have, should not demonstrate this capacity.

. . . . . .

In an analysis of medieval urbanization in Pisa, Greifswald, and other European settlements, researchers drew on modern urban scaling theory, which posits that population density in core urban areas increases as a city grows larger. Hypothesizing that this typical relationship would have differed in medieval settlements because of the constraining influence of strong hierarchical social structures (which are much less pronounced in modern cities) on social networking and economic integration drivers of urban agglomeration the team created a model that accounted for the presence of restrictive institutions. They found that the typically expected density-size relationship held for each of the 173 medieval settlements whose growth they analyzed, suggesting that _____.

9

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. although there tends to be a positive relationship between population size and development of core urban areas for both medieval settlements and modern cities, social institutions likely limited the rate at which population density increased in medieval settlements.

B. despite a change in the role of social structures over time, there is likely a notable consistency between medieval settlements and modern cities in underlying elements of the social and economic interactions among individuals that shape the development of core urban areas.

C. the social and economic dynamics that affect urban agglomeration were likely much different in medieval settlements than in modern cities, despite the similarity across time in population density patterns.

D. the constraining influence of hierarchical medieval institutions likely had a significant effect on individuals in some social groupings but little to no effect on members of other social groupings.

In recent years, the English writer Mary Ann Browne (1812 – 1845), whose poetry was widely read during her lifetime, has been rediscovered by contemporary audiences-a resurgence of interest that is largely due to literary scholars such as Adriana Craciun, whose work _____ the richness of Browne's poems and the poet's historical importance to the Romantic literary movement encourages a broader rethinking of British Romanticism itself.

10

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. highlights

B. highlighting

C. has highlighted

D. is highlighting

The French emperor Napoleon accomplished much during his sixteen-year reign: he conquered nearly all of Europe, initiated liberal reforms, and reorganized the political system of the entire continent. _____ Among legal scholars, he is best known for his creation of the Napoleonic Code, which abolished feudal privileges and created a system based on the principle of equality under the law.

11

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. for instance,

B. however,

C. likewise,

D. therefore,

Text 1
The land that became Grande Terre island split from remnants of the former supercontinent Gondwana approximately 80 million years ago, carrying Gondwanan biota with it, and experienced periodic submersion until 37 million years ago. Some researchers posit that the island's current biota includes members of Gondwanan clades (i.e., clades predating the split) that persisted by seeking temporary refuge on nearby islands during submergence events.

Text 2
In a recent study, Prashant Sharma and Gonzalo Giribet found that the crown age-the age of the most recent common ancestor of all species in the clade (i.e., the clade's founder) is 48.9 million years for Grande Terre's clade of harvest spiders. Most of the island's extant biota belong to clades with younger crown ages, however; Jérôme Murienne et al. found that the crown age of Grande Terre's clade of cockroaches is 2.7 million years, for example.

12

Taken together, Text 1 and Text 2 best support which statement about the clades of harvest spiders and cockroaches on Grande Terre?

A. The clade of harvest spiders must have originated on Gondwana, but the clade of cockroaches may or may not have.

B. Both the clade of harvest spiders and the clade of cockroaches originated elsewhere and colonized Grande Terre.

C. Neither the clade of harvest spiders nor the clade of cockroaches originated on Gondwana.

D. The clade of harvest spiders originated before Grande Terre split from Gondwana, whereas the clade of cockroaches originated after the split but before the periodic submergence events began.

Several sociologists have observed that the word "culture," though commonly used in academic literature, is an ultimately hazy concept-for example, Victoria Bonnell and Lynn Hunt have noted that "many critics have pointed to the vagueness of the concept of culture." Does the concept of culture encompass knowledge, or laws, or both these things and others? For casual usage, such haziness is permissible-we know culture when we see it-but for researchers, a standardization of the term is called for if sociology is to truly progress.

13

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

A. It lists two essential components of what is referred to by Bonnell and Hunt as "culture."

B. It presents a point regarding the definition of "culture" on which nonspecialists and specialists tend to disagree.

C. It describes the questions first raised by Bonnell and Hunt's inquiry into the meaning of the word "culture."

D. It illustrates a difficulty associated with the meaning of "culture" that the author believes holds back an academic field.

The following text is adapted from William Shakespeare's 1597 play The Tragedy of King Richard III. Richard is reflecting on the recent arrest of his brother, the Duke of Clarence, on suspicion of treason against King Edward IV. Derby, Hastings, Buckingham, Rivers, Dorset, and Grey are also members of the English nobility.

RICHARD: I do the wrong, and first begin to brawl.
The secret mischiefs that I set [flowing]
I lay unto the grievous charge of others.
Clarence, whom indeed I love, I cast in darkness,
I do beweep to many simple [gullible] people,
Namely, to Derby, Hastings, Buckingham;
And tell them 'tis the Queen and not my allies
That stir the King against the Duke my brother.
Now they believe it, and withal whet me
To be revenged on Rivers, Dorset, Grey.

14

Which choice best describes what happens in the text?

A. Richard attributes Clarence's troubles to both his own secret plotting and the distrust of Clarence that the queen and her allies Derby, Hastings, and Buckingham have planted in the king's mind.

B. Richard describes having wept as he informed Derby, Hastings, and Buckingham that the queen and her allies convinced the king to act against Clarence, and says that the earnestness of his grief caused them to accept his version of events.

C. Richard indicates that he has pretended to be aggrieved about Clarence's situation and has proclaimed it to be the fault of the queen and her allies, but in reality, he has caused the hostility the king feels toward Clarence.

D. Richard acknowledges that his mischievous nature has spurred him to commit misdeeds in the past, including instigating enmity between the king and Clarence, but he reports that he has hitherto not lost the trust of the queen and her allies.

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Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**A**	2	**B**
3	**D**	4	**C**
5	**B**	6	**B**
7	**D**	8	**B**
9	**B**	10	**B**
11	**B**	12	**C**
13	**D**	14	**C**

September 2025

14 Questions

DIRECTIONS

Prabuddha De et al. found that a recommender system (RS)-an algorithm that generates personalized product suggestions for online shoppers-impacted consumer behavior and increased sales, a result that was corroborated by Dokyun Lee and Kartik Hosanagar. However, Lee and Hosanagar also determined that whereas an RS had a stronger positive effect on item views for utilitarian products (e.g., toothbrushes) than for hedonic products (e.g., chocolates), the RS had a stronger positive effect on likelihood of purchase for hedonic products than for utilitarian ones.

1

Information in the text best supports which statement about recommender systems?

A. While recommender systems can affect consumer behavior toward suggested products, those effects are not uniform in nature and strength across product categories.

B. By directing customers toward specific product categories on a retailer's website, recommender systems may limit the variety of items seen by online shoppers.

C. While recommender systems cause consumers to spend more time viewing utilitarian items such as toothbrushes, recommender systems" positive effect on purchase rates is likely limited to hedonic items such as chocolates.

D. By proposing the most useful options to consumers, recommender systems boost the online visibility of utilitarian items that otherwise tend to be overlooked.

Probabilistic models generate predictions based on outcomes of analogous past events, but even as these models project likely outcomes, they implicitly acknowledge that lower-frequency events may occur instead. Because they accommodate multiple potential outcomes, such models may seem incompatible with causal determinism-the view that particular outcomes are inevitable given certain preconditions. But complete foreknowledge of relevant conditions is generally unavailable, suggesting that a state of uncertainty ultimately prevails in which outcomes can be predicted but not definitively foretold.

2

What does the text most strongly imply about the relationship between probabilistic models and causal determinism?

A. The predictive use of probabilistic models can be reconciled with acceptance of causal determinism because causal determinism does not necessarily entall the existence of absolute certainty.

B. The predictive use of probabilistic models represents a rejection of causal determinism because such models associate a single event with multiple potential outcomes.

C. Probabilistic models reflect the influence of causal determinism because their predictions of future outcomes are informed by concrete information about past events.

D. Probabilistic models can be understood as compatible with causal determinism only when their predictions of future events overwhelmingly favor one potential outcome.

Text 1

Mint is widely recognized for its cooling sensation. This trigeminal effect-distinct from the five basic tastes-is activated by cold receptors in the mouth. In 2012, to define the pure cooling intensity, scientists David Lee and Amanda Garcia used solutions derived from crystallized menthol, and panels of trained judges provided consistent ratings of the sensation's strength.

Text 2

A 2023 study by Elena Rodriguez et al. advanced the understanding of peppermint oil's sensory profile. The team initially tested a solution of pure menthol, which tasters described as having a sharp, medicinal quality unlike natural oil. Further analysis of peppermint oil identified specific esters, including menthyl acetate, that softened the cooling effect and contributed floral notes. The team then formulated a blend of compounds that replicated the oil's nuanced character.

3

Based on the texts, if Lee and Garcia (Text 1) and Rodriguez et al. (Text 2) were aware of the findings of both experiments, they would most likely agree with which statement?

A. On average, consumers in the United States prefer mint products with fewer esters than consumers in other regions do.

B. Chemical compounds that produce floral notes and soften cooling tend to have lower volatility than those that only produce cooling.

C. Distillation introduces impurities responsible for the medicinal quality of menthol, and those impurities also reduce the perception of sweetness.

D. The solutions in the 2012 experiment most likely did not have a substantial amount of the esters that played a key part in the 2023 experiment.

Paleontologists think that Anhanguera, Saltasaurus, and other long-extinct pterosaurs and sauropods may have breathed using air sacs connected to tubelike extensions inside the animals' bones. Such structures are found in modern birds, which is why some paleontologists treat the respiratory systems of birds as those of Anhanguera, Saltasaurus, and other pterosaurs and sauropods.

4

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. emissaries for

B. subordinates of

C. harbingers of

D. proxies for

To boost the performance of oil-absorbing resins, which are used to remove oil and other organic compounds from wastewater, one team of materials researchers created a resin with a novel-albeit very expensive-monomer (a molecule that can chemically bond with analogous molecules to form polymers) synthesized from β-cyclodextrin. Other researchers have produced resins consisting of various much cheaper, commercially available methacrylate monomers, including one derived from benzyl methacrylate (BZMA). Testing all these resins' capacity to absorb toluene and trichloromethane, two organic compounds, a scientist concluded that when practical considerations were taken into account, the BZMA-derived resin showed the greatest potential for use in wastewater cleanup.

5

Which finding, if true, would most directly support the scientist's conclusion?

A. Whereas the resin synthesized from β-cyclodextrin exhibited the highest absorption capacity for toluene, the BZMA-derived resin and other resins consisting of commercially available methacrylate monomers exhibited the highest absorption capacity for trichloromethane.

B. For both toluene and trichloromethane, the BZMA-derived resin exhibited similar absorption capacity as other resins consisting of commercially available methacrylate monomers and a slightly higher absorption capacity than the resin synthesized from β-cyclodextrin.

C. For both toluene and trichloromethane, the BZMA-derived resin exhibited only modestly lower absorption capacity than the resin synthesized from β-cyclodextrin but higher absorption capacity than other resins consisting of commercially available methacrylate monomers.

D. Relative to the resin synthesized from β-cyclodextrin and to other resins consisting of commercially available methacrylate monomers, the BZMA-derived resin exhibited superior absorption capacity for toluene but not for trichloromethane.

Studies have demonstrated that positive feedback enhances real-world exercise performance and exercisers' psychological experience of physical activity. Nicole Trewick and team tested their prediction that positive feedback would produce analogous results among participants cycling on a stationary bike in a virtual reality environment. After monitoring participants' pedaling rate and heart rate to determine the effects on their physical endurance (e.g., their ability to sustain a certain target pedaling and heart rate) of feedback (positive, negative, or neutral) delivered at regular intervals, the researchers used participants' questionnaire responses to assess their psychological experience of the task.

6

Assuming participants had similar baseline fitness levels, which finding from the study, if true, would most strongly suggest that positive feedback had the predicted psychological effect but not the predicted physical effect?

A. Compared with participants who received negative or neutral feedback, participants who received positive feedback reported greater enjoyment of the activity on average but maintained their heart and pedaling rates for approximately similar durations.

B. Compared with participants who received positive or neutral feedback, participants who received negative feedback reported lower enjoyment of the activity on average but maintained their heart and pedaling rates for longer durations.

C. Compared with participants who received negative feedback, participants who received neutral feedback reported similar levels of enjoyment of the activity on average but maintained their heart and pedaling rates for shorter durations than participants who received positive feedback.

D. Compared with participants who received positive feedback, participants who received neutral feedback reported lower enjoyment of the activity on average but maintained their heart and pedaling rates for longer durations than participants who received negative feedback.

Advancements like the emergence of glassmaking in Mesopotamia circa 3500 BCE are overemphasized in innovation studies, contributing to the idea that technological change always brings greater complexity. Research by Nathaniel Erb-Satullo reveals an important exception: gold metallurgy flourished in the Caucasus in the Bronze Age, but a steep drop during that time (circa 1500 BCE) in objects featuring gold filigree (in which fine threads of gold are arranged in intricate patterns) and other sophisticated goldsmithing techniques suggests that simpler processes supplanted advanced methods.

7

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It details the near-consensus among researchers in a particular field of study regarding how technology evolves and then indicates the controversial nature of a study challenging that broadly accepted view.

B. It summarizes the findings of several studies into the origins of a particular invention and then presents additional evidence from a more recent study that contradicts those findings.

C. It advances a claim made by researchers in one academic field about the nature of technological change and then critiques a contrasting claim presented by a researcher from a related academic field.

D. It explains that a particular interpretation of technological development has been perpetuated in an academic field and then provides a counterexample demonstrating that the interpretation isn't always accurate.

SATASHKENT

In their meta-analysis of research on advergames (video games developed to promote products or services), Zeph M.C. van Berlo et al. confirm that such games, though they can elicit player interest, may not facilitate subsequent recall of product and brand information. This phenomenon can be explained by the finite nature of cognitive capacity as it is articulated in Annie Lang's limited capacity model of motivated mediated message processing. In this case, players' cognitive resources are directed foremost toward the advergame's mechanics, leaving little or no capacity for encoding and storing the information the advertiser intends to be salient.

8

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The limited capacity model of motivated mediated message processing developed by Lang provides a means of explaining the finding by van Berlo et al. that players may not readily recollect the brand and product information embedded in advergames.

B. The meta-analysis by van Berlo et al. reveals that higher engagement in advergame mechanics is linked to lower effectiveness in persuading players to purchase particular brands and products.

C. Research by van Berlo et al. corroborates Lang's conclusion that because people predominantly focus on game mechanics when playing video games, it is difficult for advergames to communicate brand and product information in ways that are highly memorable.

D. Although the limited capacity model of motivated mediated message processing developed by Lang suggests otherwise, advergames can succeed as marketing tools, provided that they achieve a balance between game mechanics and the promotion of a brand or product.

SATASHKENT

The following text is Emily Dickinson's circa 1859 poem "Setting Sail."

Exultation is the going
Of an inland soul to sea,
Past the houses, past the headlands,
Into deep eternity!
Bred as we, among the mountains,
Can the sailor understand
The divine intoxication
Of the first league out from land?

9

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. The speaker recounts feeling profoundly moved by a recent undertaking, then questions the widespread perception that such undertakings are unremarkable.

B. The speaker depicts a common attitude at the outset of a journey, then contrasts that attitude with the speaker's state of mind after embarking on an actual journey.

C. The speaker acknowledges the allure of novel experiences, then hints at the danger of failing to appreciate what is familiar.

D. The speaker characterizes the experience of a particular emotion by way of a comparison, then extends that comparison to accentuate the intensity of that emotion.

Text 1

The University of Chicago and the online class provider Udacity are two of the many institutions offering training programs in entrepreneurship. But what results do such programs produce? In a study of college students in Scotland, researcher Laura Galloway and colleagues addressed this question and reported that participants who received entrepreneurial training showed positive attitudes toward entrepreneurship.

Text 2

While studies of entrepreneurial training typically report positive results, a close look at these studies reveals widespread methodological shortcomings. This research literature is plagued by unclear hypotheses, insufficient sample sizes, a lack of control groups, and failures to establish pretraining baselines for the measured attributes of participants.

10

Based on the texts, the author of Text 2 would most like to know the answer to which question about Galloway and colleagues' study that is not addressed in Text 1?

A. Did Galloway and colleagues measure any attributes of the participants in the study after they had received the training?

B. Did Galloway and colleagues compare Scottish college students who received the training with a group of successful entrepreneurs who did not receive the training?

C. How many Scottish college students did Galloway and colleagues include in the study?

D. Did the participants that Galloway and colleagues included in the study share any characteristics or life circumstances?

Studies of Cougar Population Density

Study authors	Location	Methods	Study area (square kilometers)	Maximum density (cougars per 100 square kilometers)
Linda L. Sweanor et al.	New Mexico (United States)	radio-collar tracking	2,059	2.00
Juan I. Zanón-Martinez et al.	Argentina	regular camera trapping	1,179	4.90
Gregory A. Davidson et al.	Oregon (United States)	scat-detecting dogs	1,225	5.50
Robin E. Russell et al.	Montana (United States)	biopsy darting, snow backtracking	8,800	6.70

Studies of the population density of cougars (Puma concolor) have yielded a range of results, which may in part reflect differences in the effectiveness of the methods that researchers have used in their studies. For example, the difference between the maximum population density reported by Linda L. Sweanor et al. and that reported by Robin E. Russell et al. might be artificially large if the use of _____.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the example?

A. biopsy darting and snow backtracking underestimates the density of cougars.

B. radio-collar tracking is impractical outside of New Mexico.

C. biopsy darting and snow backtracking is more common in Montana than the use of radio-collar tracking is.

D. radio-collar tracking underestimates the density of cougars.

12

Vegetation has two primary mechanisms by which it reduces air pollution: deposition (absorption of pollutants) and, the more effective, dispersion (dilution of pollutants by ventilation). Accordingly, establishment of green space to reduce major air pollutants such as fine particulate matter in urban areas receives considerable attention. Research by Zander S. Venter et al. comprised data from air-quality monitoring stations in Austria, the US state of California, and thousands of other global locations over a tenyear span, coupled with aerial imagery of those locations from the same period. The researchers ultimately recommended that reducing anthropogenic emissions remain the primary focus of urban air-quality improvement efforts.

Which finding from the study, if true, would most directly account for the recommendation by Venter et al.?

A. The association between levels of fine particulate matter and green space is strongly negative for locations containing or in close proximity to major cities but becomes insignificant for more rural locations.

B. The association between green space and fine particulate matter levels is moderately negative overall but becomes slightly negative and sometimes positive when consideration is limited to busy streets with tree cover heavy enough to hinder ventilation.

C. There is a predictable relationship between a location's typical climate conditions and the efficacy of green spaces in that location, but anomalous local weather events have an outsized effect on deposition and dispersion of fine particulate matter.

D. Ambient levels of fine particulate matter are comparable across locations with comparable local infrastructure (e.g., typical building shape) but vary considerably depending on the predominant type of vegetation present.

Canada, which, according to international indices, has relatively strong democratic institutions and low intranational income inequality, experienced an inflation rate of 2.26% in 2018, whereas Oman, which shows the opposite pattern on such indices, had an inflation rate of only 0.88% that year. Such a comparison may seem consistent with the theoretical critique that by diluting control over the economy, democratic institutions inhibit states' ability to counteract inflationary pressures, but when Raj Desai et al. examined democratic strength, intranational inequality, and inflation in more than 100 countries, they found that democratic strength, if associated with low inequality, restrains inflationary pressures, which would suggest that _____.

13

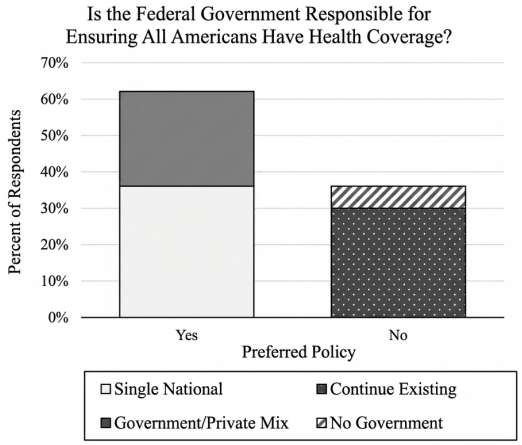
Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. international indices may have underestimated the strength of Canada's democratic institutions relative to Oman's.

B. inflation in Canada in 2018 would have been higher if Canada's government had less control over the economy.

C. factors other than Canada's political structure contributed to the country's inflation rate exceeding that of Oman in 2018.

D. the 2018 difference between Canada's inflation rate and Oman's inflation rate is primarily but not exclusively attributable to the different levels of intranational income inequality in the two countries.



Americans face a long-standing controversy over the proper role of the government in ensuring health care for its citizens. While many Americans struggle to afford health insurance from private companies, existing government programs provide low or no-cost healthcare for the elderly and the poor. In many other countries, a single national plan provides government-funded healthcare to all. A survey asked 11,000 adults whether the government should make sure Americans have healthcare coverage. The survey found that a significant number of individuals support helping some citizens but not others. While 37% of respondents believe that the government is not responsible for ensuring all Americans have access to healthcare, _____.

14

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to illustrate the claim?

A. a nearly equal percentage believe the government should provide a single, national healthcare program.

B. the overwhelming majority of those same respondents support maintaining existing government healthcare programs.

C. 6% support eliminating all government involvement in healthcare.

D. a majority of those who support government responsibility for health coverage want to use a mix of private and government programs to provide health care.

September 2025

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**A**	2	**A**
3	**D**	4	**D**
5	**C**	6	**A**
7	**D**	8	**A**
9	**D**	10	**C**
11	**D**	12	**B**
13	**C**	14	**B**

SATASHKENT

October 2025

12 Questions

DIRECTIONS

Described in treatises mainly published between 1768 and 1950 (such as W.D. Dunton's Dunton's Musical Shorthand), musical stenography used quickly written squiggles and dots in an attempt to preserve, in print and in real time, the features of live performances-those that result from impromptu deviations of performers when fidelity to an established musical score is not mandated.

1

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. inevitable

B. extemporaneous

C. inconspicuous

D. meticulous

2

Country	Percent change in total production	Percent change in market prices
Argentina	+0.90	+1.02
India	-1.34	-1.98
Russia	-3.48	-0.99
United States	+1.76	+0.44

A tariff is a tax on imported goods intended to protect domestic producers of similar goods from international competition. Eliminating tariffs can lead to an influx of cheaper imported goods, lowering prices; in a place where domestic production is relatively expensive, this influx can suppress domestic production, as the country's consumers favor more cheaply produced imported goods over domestically produced ones. A student consults a table showing projected changes in production and average market prices of agricultural commodities in four countries in a tariff-elimination scenario. Based on the data, the student claims that compared with India and Russia, agricultural production in Argentina and the United States is likely relatively inexpensive.

Which choice most effectively uses information from the text and data from the table to support the student's claim?

A. Although agricultural production in India and Russia would likely decrease if tariffs were eliminated, it would likely increase in both Argentina and the United States.

B. Although eliminating tariffs would likely cause agricultural market prices to decrease in most locations, it would likely cause agricultural market prices to increase in both Argentina and the United States.

C. Argentina and the United States are the only countries shown that are projected to see both an increase in agricultural production and a reduction in agricultural prices in the absence of tariffs.

D. In the absence of tariffs, total agricultural production in Argentina and the United States would likely exceed that in India and Russia.

Paleoanthropologists have struggled to determine the onset of consistent clothing use by hominids. The appearance of hide-scraping tools by 780,000 years ago (780 Ka) enabled clothing production but does not entail it, and while clothing is thought to have been thermally superfluous for anatomically modern humans in their African range around their emergence by 300 Ka, it was essential for the persistence of humans outside Africa by 70 Ka. Melissa Toups et al. proposed a novel proxy: the evolution of the clothing-exclusive variant of the human-exclusive parasite Pediculus humanus (head lice), which Toups et al. date to as early as 170 Ka. This variant could not have emerged and survived without ample ecological niches, so if Toups et al. are correct, then _____.

3

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. it is unlikely that hominids other than anatomically modern humans produced or wore clothing even though tools enabling the production of clothing existed well before the emergence of humans.

B. humans most likely began regularly wearing clothing at some point after 170 Ka but before approximately 70 Ka.

C. a substantial proportion of humans must have regularly worn clothing long before humans permanently inhabited areas cold enough to necessitate doing so.

D. the spread of regular clothing use among humans after approximately 70 Ka may have been motivated by factors other than the thermal benefits that clothing provides.

In 1990, oil prices rose 90% between August and October, creating what economists term an oil shock. Although oil shocks have occurred multiple times since 1945, a broadly applicable description of how oil shocks affect economies at the national level has proved elusive, a problem typically attributed to the fact that oil shocks' effects are substantially conditioned on country-specific characteristics (oil import-export ratios, most importantly). Recently, however, Gbabedo Oladosu et al. showed that economists' estimates of national economies' responsiveness to oil prices are highly heterogeneous even within a given country and time frame-ranging by more than a factor of five in the case of Australia during a recent oil shock, for instance-suggesting that
.

4

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. differences in oil import-export ratios from one country to another may account for more of the differences in the effects of oil shocks on those countries' economies than economists previously believed.

B. methodological discrepancies in studies of oil shocks may have contributed to economists' inability to provide a generalized model of oil shocks' effects on national economies.

C. economists' conventional measures of national economic activity may be insufficiently sensitive to the effects of oil shocks.

D. controlling for variations in countries' oil import-export ratios might not resolve the difficulties economists have had in constructing a broadly applicable description of oil shocks' effects.

The many editions of James Joyce's 1922 novel Ulysses are not textually identical, and scholars debate which versions reflect Joyce's authorial intent. One no longer widely read edition is the 1984 "critical and synoptic edition" edited by Hans Walter Gabler, which followed French and German editorial theories rather than editorial traditions of the United States and United Kingdom and which was later found to have introduced errors due to Gabler's choice to consult facsimile manuscripts rather than using only originals. However, few Joyce scholars worldwide had expertise in such textual issues, and most of those who did worked on the edition with Gabler. So, it is unsurprising that initial scholarly reviews of the 1984 edition were mostly _____.

5

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. negative, since those joyce scholars with the necessary expertise to write a review of the 1984 edition would be aware that facsimile manuscripts cannot be produced with a high enough fidelity to the original in ensure that relying on them will not introduce editorial errors.

B. positive, since Ulysses is a novel in English and the 1984 edition would therefore be more widely reviewed in United States and United Kingdom publications than in French and German publications.

C. positive, since scholars who reviewed the 1984 edition were unaffiliated with its production and were mostly either Joyce specialists who were largely unfamiliar with editorial theories and practices or specialists in such theories and practices who were insufficiently familiar with joyce.

D. negative, since any scholar with expertise in editorial theories of the United States and United Kingdom as well as French and German editorial theories most likely worked with Gabler on the 1984 edition and would therefore not review it.

SATASHKENT

Data collected by the Mars rover Curiosity at the Gale Crater's Murray Formation are suggestive of hydrological deposition of sediment in the distant past. To characterize the nature of the depositional environment, Frances Rivera-Hernández et al. analyzed the grain size of Murray Formation sediment, finding that although there are intervals of coarse grains, most of the sediment consists of fine grains that show signs of cracking due to episodic desiccation. Rivera-Hernández et al. concluded that the coarse grains are sandstone, which tends to be deposited by flowing water, whereas the fine grains are mudstone, which is slowly deposited by settling out of suspension in low-flow water, leading the researchers to posit that _____.

6

Which choice most logically completes the text?

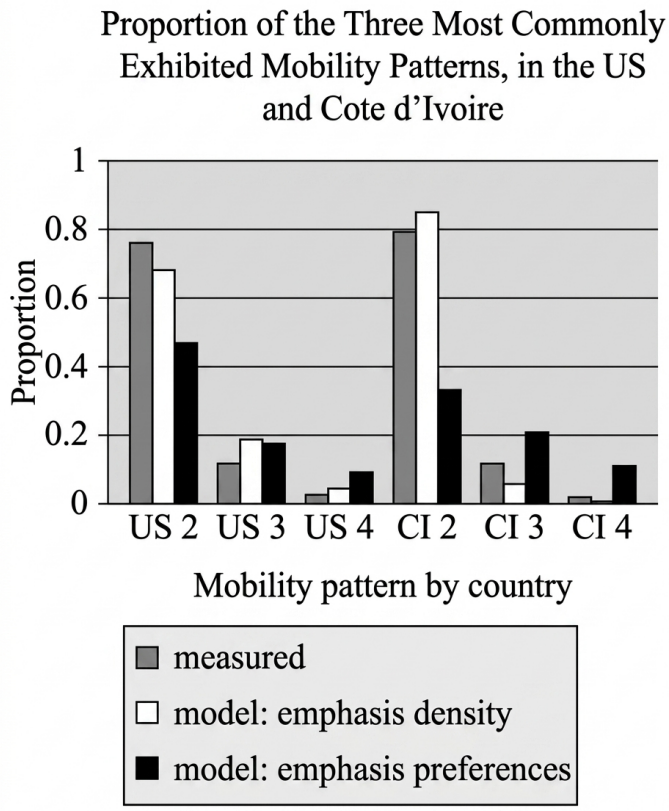
A. although the area of the Murray Formation experienced a prolonged period of dryness that prevented a lake from forming, water flowing from a distant source was present.

B. one or more streams existed at the Murray Formation for an extended period until being replaced by a lake that persisted for only a brief period before permanently drying.

C. a stream-fed lake was present at the Murray Formation for an extended period, and although the streams experienced occasional drying, the lake did not.

D. a lake existed at the Murray Formation for a prolonged period, though the lake occasionally experienced drying and there were periods in which one or more streams were present.

SATASHKENT



Researchers used anonymized location data from the US and Côte d'Ivoire to document people's daily patterns of mobility, using these results to test the efficacy of the researchers' predictive computer model. In each country, unidirectional cycles among two, three, or four locations were empirically the most common pattern types; the graph shows each of these pattern types as a proportion of all pattern instances found for that country (e.g., the measured value for CI 3 in the graph, 0.12, indicates that the three-location pattern constituted 12% of all pattern instances in the Côte d'Ivoire data). The researchers ran their model twice under different assumptions, concluding that emphasizing the salience of local population density over personal preferences generally yielded the best results.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to illustrate the claim?

A. Under the assumption that density is more salient than preferences, the US 2 and CI 2 proportions are approximately 0.65 and 0.85, respectively, significantly higher than the values predicted under the other assumption and thus farther than those predictions from the measured values.

B. Under the assumption that preferences are more salient than density, the two-location patterns (US 2 and CI 2) were predicted to be most frequent in the data even though neither proportion was projected to exceed 0.5, well below the proportion predicted under the other assumption.

C. Under the assumption that preferences are more salient than density, the US 2 and CI 2 proportions were predicted to be in the range of 0.3 to 0.5, placing them farther from the measured values than were those predicted under the other assumption.

D. Under the assumption that preferences are more salient than density, the US 2 and CI 2 proportions were predicted to be approximately 0.45 and 0.35, respectively, both below the measured values, whereas under the other assumption, the model overestimated the proportion for US 2 and overestimated that for CI 2.

Alabama is one of several US states to enact statutes supporting the incorporation of worker cooperatives, businesses with democratic governance. Many scholars testify to the economic sustainability of the co-op model while acknowledging its challenges. _____ those who declare the model inherently unviable can discount documented successes, while those who champion it may understate its challenges.

8

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. That said, some experts overlook such nuance;

B. Nevertheless, how these challenges might be overcome remains contentious;

C. Ultimately, these complex issues require complex solutions;

D. Thus, the scholars are skeptical about the co-op model's viability;

In a 2020 paper, Arya Udry et al. cautioned that although similarities in the isotopic signatures of elements detected in Mars's atmosphere and in Martian meteorites recovered on Earth make it tempting to treat the geochemical properties of the meteorites as _____ those of Mars's interiors, Mars's geology cannot be ascertained based solely on meteorite-sample analyses.

9

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. proxies for

B. contrivances of

C. catalysts of

D. deterrents to

Scientists study the abundance and the activity ratios (AR) the relative radioactive decay rates of two isotopes of uranium (U) isotopes in bodies of water to track sediment transport and deposition and to monitor groundwater quality. However, isotope abundance and AR are not always uniform across a single body of water, which may affect the reliability of results if sampling is not sufficiently representative. Chen Zhao et al. analyzed concentrations of the isotope U-238 and the $\frac{\text{U-234}}{\text{U-238}}$ AR at multiple depths and locations in two lakes in China, finding no significant variation in values within the same lake.

10

Information in the text best supports which statement about Zhao et al.'s findings?

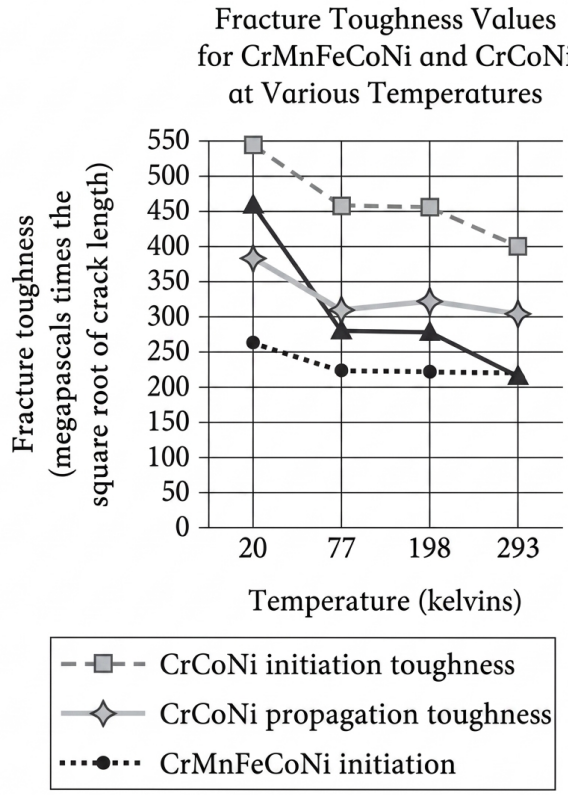
A. They illustrate why scientists investigating sediment transport and deposition and groundwater quality ought to evaluate how evenly U abundance and AR are distributed in the bodies of water they are examining.

B. They challenge the assumption that U abundance and AR sometimes vary from lake to lake, since the U-238 concentration and $\frac{\text{U-234}}{\text{U-238}}$ AR were consistent across the sampled lakes.

C. They indicate that researchers performing isotopic analysis in the lakes Zhao et al. studied can likely rely on localized sampling within each lake, since values from any one location or depth are representative of the entire lake.

D. They demonstrate that the number of samples Zhao et al. collected from the two lakes is sufficient to yield equally reliable information about sediment transport and deposition and groundwater quality in those two lakes.

SATASHKENT



High entropy alloys (HEAs) typically combine five or more elements in roughly equal proportions, and medium entropy alloys (MEAs) typically combine three or four elements in similar proportions. HEAs and MEAs are known for withstanding cracking at extremely low (cryogenic) temperatures relatively well, though their fracture toughness generally falls as temperature does. Dong Liu et al. investigated the fracture toughness (both the initiation and propagation toughness) of the HEA CrMnFeCoNi and its MEA derivative CrCoNi and concluded that the alloys' toughness performance differs from that of most HEAs and MEAs.

Which choice best describes data in the graph that support Liu et al.'s conclusion?

A. CrCoNi outperformed CrMnFeCoNi at 20 kelvins in both initiation toughness and propagation toughness even though it is composed of fewer elements.

B. Both CrMnFeCoNi and CrCoNi showed substantially higher propagation toughness than initiation toughness throughout the range from 20 kelvins to 293 kelvins.

C. The changes in initiation toughness and propagation toughness were greater between 20 kelvins and 77 kelvins than between 77 kelvins and 198 kelvins for both CrMnFeCoNi and CrCoNi.

D. For both CrMnFeCoNi and CrCoNi, initiation toughness and propagation toughness were lower at 293 kelvins than at 20 kelvins.

The Enchanted April is a 1922 novel by Elizabeth von Arnim. In the novel, Lady Caroline and three other English women are vacationing at an Italian castle. In the course of the trip, Lady Caroline comes to feel a sense of bitterness that she conceals from her companions: _____.

12

Which quotation from The Enchanted April most effectively illustrates the claim?

A. "And Lady Caroline, sitting where [the others] had left her before breakfast on the wall, peeped over when she heard laughter, and saw them standing on the path below, and thought what a mercy it was they were laughing down there and had not come up and done it round her."

B. "The idea that [Lady Caroline] would go on giving orders was too absurd. She never gave orders at home. Nobody there dreamed of asking her to do anything. That such a very tiresome activity should be thrust upon her here, simply because she happened to be able to talk Italian, was ridiculous."

C. "What does one do with people like this?' [Lady Caroline asked herself, her eyes fixed on Mrs. Fisher in what felt to her an indignant stare but appeared to Mrs. Fisher as really charming docility."

D. "A deep cynicism took hold of the unhappy [Lady Caroline]. Her inside grew hoary with disillusionment, while her gracious and charming outside continued to make the world more beautiful."

October 2025

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**B**	2	**A**
3	**B**	4	**D**
5	**C**	6	**A**
7	**A**	8	**A**
9	**A**	10	**C**
11	**A**	12	**D**

November 2025

15 Questions

DIRECTIONS

Yuen Yuen Ang et al. argue that merely tallying the number of patents filed per year _____ the degree of innovation occurring: truly novel patents-those, like a 2011 patent for an automated navigation system for planes, that combine previously unaffiliated technological domains-are vastly outnumbered by more common patents (e.g., a 2008 patent for a method of making soup).

1

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. belies

B. portends

C. thwarts

D. maligns

Richard II is a play from the 1590s by William Shakespeare. Although King Richard has been vanquished by his cousin Henry Bolingbroke, he intimates that he is not entirely ready to show subservience to his cousin, saying, _____.

2

Which quotation from Richard II most effectively illustrates the claim?

A. "Am I both priest and clerk? Well then, amen. / God save the King! although I be not he; / And yet, amen, if heaven do think him me."

B. "I have no name, no title, - / No, not that name was given me at the font,- / But 'tis usurp'd: Alack the heavy day. / That I have worn so many winters out, / And know not now what name to call myself!"

C. "Still my griefs are mine. / You may my glories and my state depose, / But not my griefs; still am I king of those."

D. "Alack, why am I sent for to a king, / Before I have shook off the regal thoughts / Wherewith I reign'd? I hardly yet have learn'd / To insinuate, flatter, bow, and bend my knee."

_____ the mythological and heroic subject matter often found in works by Horace Vernet and other establishment figures, Honoré Daumier's painting The Third-Class Carriage instead focuses on something decidedly mundane: working-class travelers in a third-class railway car.

3

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. Eschewing

B. Expounding

C. Caricaturing

D. Appraising

Establishing protected areas (PAs), such as Abrolhos Marine National Park in Brazil, is a common conservation strategy, but because PAs restrict some kinds of economic activity, it's widely thought that they hinder economic development. This perception is driven in part by the fact that economic assessments often don't capture the indirect effects of tourism linked to PAs. But Heng Zhu et al. found that tourism associated with Abrolhos boosts local demand for goods and services in other economic sectors, resulting in, for instance, increased income from fishing in nearby areas.

4

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It states a hypothesis that accounts for why PAs generally negatively impact local economies, outlines how a research team's findings support that hypothesis, and then suggests how a novel methodology led a separate team of researchers to a different conclusion.

B. It makes a generalization about the difficulty of using PAs to reconcile economic and conservation priorities, demonstrates why most PAs fall short of achieving that goal, and then holds up a particular PA as an example of how that goal can be achieved.

C. It introduces a widely held belief about the effect PAs have on the economy, proposes a reason for that belief's prevalence, and then details a study whose findings seemingly conflict with that belief.

D. It explains how PAs typically affect economic development in the regions where they are established, summarizes the findings of several economic studies that support this explanation, and then concedes that a particular PA is an exception to the general trend.

Linguist John McWhorter asserts that translation apps for smartphones and computers are-despite generally failing to convey many nuances-increasingly obviating the need to learn new languages. Advances in language processing technology have greatly boosted the utility of these apps for perfunctory tasks, like inquiring about an item on a menu, and passing interactions; be that as it may, richer communication (e.g., in business dealings or meaningful personal exchanges) often hinges on conversational patterns and gradations of meaning.

5

What does the text most directly suggest about translation apps?

A. They have improved remarkably over time but remain insufficient to support the complexity called for in certain interactions.

B. They are coming to be embraced by international tourists but are viewed with skepticism by many languages.

C. They are becoming simpler to use but are inconsistent in how comprehensively they convey information.

D. They have gained impressive capabilities but continue to be widely viewed as inadequate for most practical purposes.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The farm-size transition hypothesis predicts that economic pressures associated with modernization result in smaller farms amalgamating into larger-scale commercial farms.
- Masters et al. (2013): The average farm size in Asia "already has or will soon begin to rise."
- Promkhambut et al. (2023) argue that small rice farms in Thailand have adopted modern farming methods without a significant scaling-up of farm size.
- Promkhambut et al.: "The persistence of [small] rice farms [in Thailand] does not represent a 'failure' to modernize...or a 'truncated' transition-it is a response to modernization."

6

The student wants to make and support a claim regarding the applicability of the farm-size transition hypothesis to Thailand. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Although the farm-size transition hypothesis may be applicable to some countries in Asia, it is inconsistent with the development of rice farming in Thailand.

B. Taken together, the studies by Masters et al. and Promkhambut et al. suggest that rice farms in Thailand have responded to the economic pressures associated with modernization by expanding in size.

C. Masters et al. report that the average farm size "already has or will soon begin to rise" in Asia, a finding that is consistent with the farm-size transition hypothesis.

D. The predicted shift to large-scale commercial farming may not hold true for rice farms in Thailand, where, according to Promkhambut et al., rice farms have remained small as they've modernized.

Type of resolution	Age 18-29	Age 30-49	Age 50-64	Age 65+
Health and exercise	79	80	79	76
Finances	68	63	56	47
Personal relationships	63	53	58	52
Hobbies	65	53	51	45

A Pew Research Center survey conducted in January 2024 found that three out of ten US adults make at least one New Year's resolution (a promise for the year ahead), while half of those who make a resolution make more than one. The survey asked participants what kinds of resolutions they made and separated them into several categories. The table presents percentages of people who make particular kinds of New Year's resolutions among those who choose to make them, indexed by age bracket.

Which choice best presents a conclusion about the habits of New Year's resolution makers that is best supported by information in the text and the table?

A. The majority of US adults who make resolutions related to health and exercise also make resolutions in multiple additional categories.

B. Resolution makers between the ages of 50 and 64 are more likely to make resolutions related to personal relationships and less likely to make resolutions related to finances than resolution makers between the ages of 30 and 49 are.

C. Among all US adults, people become less likely to make New Year's resolutions as they age, regardless of the type of resolution.

D. Resolution makers between the ages of 18 and 29 are more likely to make resolutions about health and exercise than resolution makers between the ages of 30 and 49 are.

Duckweed is a small freshwater plant that is often exposed to zinc pollution. Sofia Vámos and colleagues collected samples of four duckweed ecotypes (genetically and geographically distinct populations within a species), along with water from each ecotype's habitat. Hypothesizing that each ecotype is adapted to its local conditions in ways that bolster its growth and resistance to pollutants, the researchers grew each ecotype in all four water samples and with three levels of zinc (none, low, high). (The researchers did not replicate local differences in light or temperature.) They found that the ecotypes grew equally well in all four water samples and that adding zinc consistently enhanced growth, regardless of concentration, suggesting that _____.

8

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. if each ecotype is indeed locally adapted as the researchers hypothesized, those adaptations are to other environmental conditions than the water each ecotype inhabits.

B. while the ecotypes are genetically and geographically distinct, those differences do not represent adaptations to local environmental conditions.

C. there may not be significant differences in the water that each ecotype inhabits, but there are significant differences in each ecotype's resistance to zinc pollution.

D. although the researchers' hypothesis does not appear to be supported, this may be because the levels of zinc exposure the plants in the experiment received did not match their exposure in their natural environments.

Scholars cite Men of Maize, the 1949 novel by Guatemalan author Miguel Ángel Asturias, as a foundational text of magical realism, the Latin American style of fiction in which antirealistic plot devices-often borrowed from the spiritual and narrative traditions of Indigenous and colonial societies in the Americas-are deployed in an otherwise realistic mode of representation typical of the modern novel. This style has exerted a decisive influence on authors in the United States, including Susan Power, whose 1994 novel The Grass Dancer resembles classic magical realist novels in its juxtaposition of literary realism with long-established cultural traditions-namely, those of the Dakota people of the northern plains.

9

Which quotation most effectively illustrates the claim?

A. "The cultural traditions of the Dakota people of the northern plains, which figure so prominently in the magical realist tradition of Latin America, permit realistic as well as antirealistic scenarios-much as The Grass Dancer does."

B. "Although much of The Grass Dancer conforms to the conventions of realistic fiction, Susan Power also incorporates elements drawn from Dakota cultural traditions that transcend and expose the limitations of realism."

C. "Even though The Grass Dancer alternates between realistic and antirealistic modes of representation, the influence of Dakota cultural traditions remains constant throughout the novel."

D. "Much of the interest of The Grass Dancer derives from the productive tension between its competing influences-namely, Dakota cultural traditions and the magical realism of Latin America."

Tomi Adeyemi's first published work, the inventive West African-inspired fantasy novel Children of Blood and Bone, has intriguing things to say about the relationship between identity and power. Adeyemi works in a decades-long tradition going back to writers such as Samuel Delany and Octavia Butler, who wove cultural elements of the Black diaspora into their science fiction and fantasy in a movement known as Afrofuturism. At its core, the movement is characterized by speculation, not just about distant futures or other planets but also about alternate versions of our shared past. Afrofuturism's meditations on authority reinvigorate the creative potential of fiction.

10

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It notes the political stance of an author, compares that author's book to other earlier works, and then analyzes the influence of political events on the book.

B. It praises a newly published author, compares that author with others who might appear superficially similar, and then points out the features of that author's work that make it unique.

C. It introduces an intriguing debut work, contextualizes that work as part of an ongoing literary tradition, and then describes important themes of that tradition.

D. It summarizes a book, describes characteristics of the artistic movement of which the book is a part, and then points out the features the book shares with more widely read works.

Recordings of electrical activity in the brain, increased activity in brain areas associated with suppressing motor functions.

11

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. electrograms show that while responding to hypothetical match scenarios, the most highly skilled soccer players have

B. hypothetical match scenario responses show that the most highly skilled soccer players captured in electrograms have

C. the most highly skilled soccer players responding to hypothetical match scenarios have electrograms that show

D. responses to hypothetical match scenarios show that the most highly skilled soccer players have

Most Native languages belong to language families, or groups of languages whose structural and lexical correspondence likely derives from their descent from a single language spoken long ago. A minority-such as Washoe, which is spoken in California and Nevada, and Chitimacha, which is spoken in Louisiana-are isolates, having no demonstrable genealogical relationship to other languages. Yet Washoe and Chitimacha, like all isolates, are potentially remnants of families whose other members vanished before the historical record could attest to them, perhaps through the geographical expansion of extant families.

12

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

A. It implies that a nonisolate language may have influenced both Washoe and Chitimacha to such a degree that their relationship to their former families is no longer discernible.

B. It suggests that the ancestral languages of both Washoe and Chitimacha were likely isolates that replaced nonisolate languages through geographic expansion in the distant past.

C. It asserts that the historical record tends to overrepresent nonisolate languages relative to isolates, such that the origins of Washoe and Chitimacha are obscure to scholars in the present day.

D. It proposes that the distinction made between present-day nonisolate languages and isolates like Washoe and Chitimacha may not have been applicable in the distant past.

The following text is adapted from Mark Twain's 1876 novel The Adventures of Tom Sawyer. Aunt Polly is having dinner with Tom, her mischievous young nephew. Aunt Polly asked [Tom] questions that were full of guile, and very deep-for she wanted to trap him into damaging revealments. Like many other simple-hearted souls, it was her pet vanity to believe she was endowed with a talent for dark and mysterious diplomacy, and she loved to contemplate her most transparent devices as marvels of low cunning.

13

Which choice best describes how Aunt Polly is presented in the text?

A. The narrator gently makes fun of Aunt Polly's mistaken confidence in her subtlety.

B. The narrator humorously exaggerates Aunt Polly's view of herself as an intellectual.

C. The narrator characterizes Aunt Polly as being excessively nosy about other people's private lives.

D. The narrator emphasizes that Aunt Polly's intentions are good even when she behaves impolitely.

In 2009, the US state of Montana enacted rate stability regulations (RSRs), constraining insurance companies' latitude to raise premiums (the recurring fees policyholders pay to maintain insurance policies) once policies are in effect. Although RSRs are intended to benefit consumers, Naoki Aizawa and Ami Ko note that RSRs could curtail insurers' profits to such a degree that insurers abandon the market, thereby reducing the competitive pressure that typically restrains premium prices for newly issued policies. To determine whether this occurred in Montana, students first collect data on the number of insurers in the state for a few years leading up to and following 2009 and the premium prices for new policies offered by those insurers.

14

Based on the text, what would be the most reasonable next step for the students to take to accomplish their goal?

A. Compare changes over time in the premium price data the students have collected with changes over time in premium prices for policies that were already in effect during the same period in an otherwise similar state that had not enacted RSRs.

B. Compare changes over time within each of the two types of data the students have collected with changes over time in analogous data for the same period from an otherwise similar state that had not enacted RSRs.

C. Compare changes over time within each of the two types of data the students have collected with changes over time in the same types of data from Montana for a period beginning several years after 2009.

D. Compare changes over time in the insurer-number data the students have collected with changes over time in insurer-number data from another state that enacted RSRs but not during the same period.

SATASHKENT

Variously, researchers have closely examined obsidian artifacts to understand ancient social and economic structures, as in Raymond V. Sidrys's 1976 study, or to glean aspects of cultural identity, as in Dennis Ogburn and colleagues' 2009 study. Studies of the Malia archaeological site on the Mediterranean island of Crete have shown that significant changes to building styles-changes consistent with an influx of people from another culture elsewhere in the Mediterranean-occurred from the Middle Bronze Age to the Late Bronze Age. In a 2022 study, however, Tristan Carter and Vassilis Kilikoglou found that obsidian-object production methods at Malia stayed remarkably consistent during this architectural transition, which they interpret as indicative of local cultural continuity in the Middle and Late Bronze Ages.

15

Which finding, if true, would most directly weaken Carter and Kilikoglou's argument?

A. The obsidian used to produce objects at Malia was transported to Crete from the same source elsewhere in the Mediterranean throughout the Middle and Late Bronze Ages.

B. The methods used to produce obsidian objects at Malia during the Middle and Late Bronze Ages were also used by some other Mediterranean cultures in the period.

C. The obsidian-object production method that was most common among other Mediterranean cultures during the Middle and Late Bronze Ages was more efficient than the method used at Malia.

D. Changes to buildings like those that occurred at Malia have not been linked to changes in obsidian-object production methods in other Mediterranean cultures during the Middle and Late Bronze Ages.

November 2025

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**A**	2	**D**
3	**A**	4	**C**
5	**A**	6	**D**
7	**B**	8	**A**
9	**B**	10	**C**
11	**A**	12	**D**
13	**A**	14	**B**
15	**B**		

December 2025

14 Questions

DIRECTIONS

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1

Type of resolution	Age 18-29	Age 30-49	Age 50-64	Age 65+
Health and exercise	79	80	79	76
Finances	68	63	56	47
Personal relationships	63	53	58	52
Hobbies	65	53	51	45

Persistence of Settlements and Compound Average Annual Population Growth Rate in the Yautepec Valley. The percent of cities and towns in a given period that persist from a prior period (backward continuity) and the percent that persist into a later period (forward continuity) are known to correlate positively with economic and political stability in a region. Researchers studying demographic trends in the Indigenous societies of ancient Mexico determined both continuity measures for the Yautepec Valley, which lay within the macroregional hegemony of the city-state of Teotihuacan from roughly 100 BCE until roughly 450 CE, after which point Teotihuacan declined. The team concluded that _____.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the text?

A. the marginal decrease in the compound average annual growth rate of the Yautepec Valley's population in the Early Classic was likely associated with the widespread abandonment of cities and towns established in the Terminal Formative.

B. values for both backward and forward continuity in the Yautepec Valley were consistently higher during the centuries of Teotihuacan's hegemony than they were in the period following the collapse of the hegemony.

C. although the forward continuity data suggest that the decline of Teotihuacan occasioned economic and political instability in the Yautepec Valley, these developments were nonetheless associated with a net increase in the valley's population.

D. Teotihuacan's hegemony imposed stability on the Yautepec Valley, mitigating the decrease in the compound average annual growth rate of the valley's population as well as the decrease in the number of cities and towns there in the Early Classic and Middle Classic.

Despite potential independent confirmation, the apparent detection in 2020 of phosphine (PH_3)—a gas that on Earth almost exclusively derives from biological sources-in Venus's cloud deck remains controversial, in part because Venus is thought to be uninhabitable. To evaluate such a finding's plausibility, William Bains et al. modeled multiple abiotic PH_3 pathways, including geochemical, atmospheric, and photochemical reactions, but none adequately explain the observed levels of PH_3. If Venusian PH_3 does exist, it would indicate insufficiencies in the current consensus on Venus's chemistry.

2

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It introduces an unexpected observation of a particular gas in Venus's atmosphere, presents an effort to investigate possible mechanisms that could explain that observation, and then notes an implication of that investigation's findings.

B. It explains why the consensus view of a particular gas in Venus's atmosphere has recently become controversial, expands on a scientific team's reasons for questioning that consensus, and then suggests that future observations of Venus's atmosphere will likely be needed to settle the controversy.

C. It compares the levels of a particular gas on Venus and Earth, sketches the chemical processes that account for differences in these levels, and then addresses some of the practical challenges of studying the presence of this gas on Venus more closely.

D. It outlines recent efforts to confirm the presence of a particular gas in Venus's atmosphere, summarizes a research team's evaluations of those efforts' methodological shortcomings, and then explains why that team remains skeptical of the gas's future detection.

In the book A Theory of Harmony (1985), Swiss musicologist Ernst Levy argued that every chord has an opposite that can be substituted for it. For example, a pianist could replace the vi chord for the bIII chord while _____ chord's opposite can be determined using a music visualization tool called the circle of fifths.

3

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. improvising which

B. improvising and which

C. improvising. Which

D. improvising, which

In 2004, the US state of North Dakota enacted rate stability regulations (RSRs), constraining insurance companies' latitude to raise premiums (the periodic fees policyholders pay to maintain insurance policies) after policies are in effect. RSRs are effective at protecting existing policyholders from price volatility, but Naoki Aizawa and Ami Ko note that since dynamic pricing of premiums is an important risk-mitigation tool for insurers, RSRs may lead some insurers to scale back or entirely cease selling new policies in the affected market, thereby reducing the competitive pressure that typically restrains premium prices for new policies. Thus, North Dakota's RSRs may _____.

4

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. be more advantageous for insurers than they are for either current or prospective policyholders.

B. benefit policyholders at the expense of nonpolicyholders seeking to acquire policies.

C. prevent large increases in premium prices for new policies despite leading to fewer insurers offering such policies in the affected market.

D. reduce premium price volatility once policies are in effect but increase risks for policyholders.

The synthesis of novel superheavy elements, such as meitnerium (Mt), has led theorists to consider the feasibility of synthesizing all possible chemical compounds. In 2022, Guillermo Restrepo calculated the historical rates at which newly discovered compounds have entered the scientific literature, expanding the "chemical space." Using a conservative estimate of the number of viable compounds and assuming a doubling of the historical pace of discovery, Restrepo found that under these hypothetical conditions, all potential compounds could be synthesized and documented by 2050.

5

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

A. It makes a comparison between the past and current rates at which new chemical compounds have entered the scientific literature.

B. It introduces information that helps explain why the synthesis of superheavy elements has rapidly expanded the chemical space.

C. It provides details about the qualification later in the sentence regarding the prospect of cataloging the full range of possible chemical compounds.

D. It emphasizes the point implicitly made earlier in the text that human inefficiency is the primary constraint on the expansion of the chemical space.

Quality assessments of concrete typically focus almost exclusively on compressive strength as a measure of durability, overlooking other potentially relevant factors. Lisa Ptacek et al. therefore investigated the potential of gas permeability (vulnerability to incursion by gases), which is caused in part by excessive porosity, as a durability indicator. Their measurements and observations revealed that quality of conditions during the concrete curing phase negatively correlates with gas permeability and that high gas permeability values are associated with increased deterioration as concrete surfaces age.

6

Information in the text best supports which statement about Ptacek et al.'s findings?

A. They suggest that gas permeability testing presents a more reliable indication of concrete durability than compressive strength testing does.

B. They bolster the claim that concrete's susceptibility to damage decreases as its gas permeability increases.

C. They call into question the idea that quality or curing conditions directly affects concrete gas permeability but is unrelated to compressive strength.

D. They indicate that evaluation of gas permeability is an appropriate addition to concrete quality assessment procedures.

The following text is from William Carlos Williams's 1925 creative nonfiction book In the American Grain. Williams is discussing how works by nineteenth-century US poet and fiction writer Edgar Allan Poe were received by American readers.

Poe must suffer by his originality. Invent that which is new, even if it be made of pine from your own yard, and there's none to know what you have done. It is because there's no name. This is the cause of Poe's lack of recognition. He was American. He was the astounding, inconceivable growth of his locality. Gape at him they did, and he at them in amazement. Afterward with mutual hatred; he in disgust, they in mistrust. It is only that which is under your nose that you cannot see.

7

What does the text most strongly suggest about Poe's work and American readers?

A. Poe's work was so innovative that there was not even terminology to describe it, which led American readers to regard both the work and Poe himself as strange but quintessentially American.

B. Poe's work had few fans among American readers because it tended to present a negative image of American life and institutions.

C. American readers largely ignored Poe's work because its tone and subject matter were out of keeping with mainstream literature.

D. American readers failed to appreciate Poe's work because of its novelty and the fact that it reflected aspects of the American character too ingrained in those readers for them to comprehend.

In an analysis of medieval urbanization in Pisa, Greifswald, and other European settlements, researchers drew on modern urban scaling theory, which posits that population density in core urban areas increases as a city grows larger. Hypothesizing that this typical relationship would have differed in medieval settlements because of the constraining influence of strong hierarchical social structures (which are much less pronounced in modern cities) on social networking and economic integration-drivers of urban agglomeration-the team created a model that accounted for the presence of restrictive institutions. They found that the typically expected density-size relationship held for each of the 173 medieval settlements whose growth they analyzed, suggesting that _____.

8

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. although there tends to be a positive relationship between population size and development of core urban areas for both medieval settlements and modern cities, social institutions likely limited the rate at which population density increased in medieval settlements.

B. despite a change in the role of social structures over time, there is likely a notable consistency between medieval settlements and modern cities in underlying elements of the social and economic interactions among individuals that shape the development of core urban areas.

C. the social and economic dynamics that affect urban agglomeration were likely much different in medieval settlements than in modern cities, despite the similarity across time in population density patterns.

D. the constraining influence of hierarchical medieval institutions likely had a significant effect on individuals in some social groupings but little to no effect on members of other social groupings.

According to climate envelope models, individuals that inhabit the coolest areas of their species' geographic distribution are expected to benefit from a warming climate, while individuals in the warmest areas will struggle. A 2024 University of Arizona study, _____ found that warmer-than-average temperatures resulted in a decrease in growth across all areas of the common piñon tree's distribution range.

9

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. though,

B. therefore,

C. for example,

D. moreover,

The Rajahnate of Butuan, a sea power based on Mindanao island in the Philippines that reached the height of its influence around 1100 CE, is classified as a thalassocracy. Thalassocracies are generally considered distinct from tellurocracies, or land-based powers. _____ the British Empire (1600s-1900s CE) notably extended its hegemony across both land and sea.

10

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. Exemplifying this distinction,

B. Underscoring this difference,

C. Supporting this claim,

D. Blurring this line,

In the Metropolitan Museum of Art's 2024 exhibition "Sleeping Beauties: Reawakening Fashion," an innovative multisensory exhibit of garments and accessories spanning four centuries, an emphasis on the _____ of fashion was conveyed both by the exhibit's theme of perpetual renewal in nature and, more subtly, by its scientific re-creations of ephemeral elements (like a fragrance worn with a dress more than a century ago).

11

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. transience

B. definitiveness

C. superficiality

D. partiality

As a defense mechanism, the monarch butterfly toxic compounds from milkweed plants. On ingesting a piece of milkweed, the monarch selectively absorbs toxic cardenolides from the plant in its gut and stores them in the tissues throughout its body, rendering the butterfly unpalatable to predators.

12

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. neutralizes

B. exploits

C. impedes

D. secretes

Guadalupe Romero Villanueva et al. conducted radiocarbon analysis of paint used in rock art at the Patagonian archaeological site Cueva Huenul 1, revealing that images of a comblike motif date to as early as 8,000 years ago, predating other paintings in the region by several millennia. The motif was subsequently reproduced multiple times at the site over the next 3,000 years, a period coinciding with extremely arid conditions and slightly negative population growth. The motif may therefore have functioned to help preserve cultural knowledge during a time of ecological and demographic stress.

13

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

A. It identifies the historical conditions that explain why production of the painted motif described in the text abruptly ceased after 3,000 years of continued use.

B. It provides context that informs the text's claim about why the peoples of Patagonia chose Cueva Huenul 1 as a culturally significant site.

C. It explains the environmental circumstances that account for the rarity of rock art dating to the same period as the motif discussed in the text.

D. It identifies a consideration that factored into an interpretation of the rock art at Cueva Huenul 1 that is presented in the text.

In addition to its deployment of dialect and other cultural signifiers, the literature of the US South is characterized by its adaptation of established fiction genres to Southern contexts. Mark Twain derived his episodic narrative structures and roguish heroes from the picaresque novel, and William Faulkner realized the decadent aristocrat, the imperiled heroine, and other character types of the Gothic novel as rural Southerners who were more contingent, more caught in the net of societal relations and history than the fantastical figures of the Gothic had been. Some of the region's poets, such as James Dickey, have shown even greater dexterity by adapting these sources in an altogether different literary form.

14

Which quotation from a literary scholar would most directly illustrate the text's claim about Southern poets?

A. "What is the disturbed, and disturbing, speaker of Dickey's best poems if not a stock character of the Gothic novel, refracted through the speech and ethos of the South and conditioned by the structures of lyric poetry?"

B. "The Gothic genre emerged in England and Ireland in the 1700s and was later naturalized to the cultural landscape of the Northeastern US, as in the novels of Nathaniel Hawthorne, which Dickey had almost certainly read."

C. "With its rural settings and rustic characters, Dickey's poems suggest the influence of the genre of pastoral fiction, yet Dickey may have instead obtained these elements from pastoral poetry, which preceded its namesake in fiction."

D. "When Dickey invokes one genre of poetry and, within the space of a few lines, abandons it for another genre of poetry, what can we infer from this gesture if not the poet's fascination with genre per se, as well as his discomfort with it?"

SATASHKENT

December 2025

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**C**	2	**A**
3	**C**	4	**B**
5	**C**	6	**D**
7	**D**	8	**B**
9	**A**	10	**D**
11	**A**	12	**B**
13	**D**	14	**A**

March 2026

14 Questions

DIRECTIONS

Karel Čapek's 1920 play R.U.R. (Rossum's Universal Robots), in which artificial workers overthrow their masters, left an indelible mark on the science fiction genre, and the English language, by introducing the term "robot" (derived from the Czech word robota, meaning "indentured labor" or "drudgery"). _____ Čapek's play also contributed to a venerable literary and mythological tradition: using artificial beings as mirrors and foils for humanity.

1

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By achieving such a lofty goal,

B. Beyond the simple coining of a term,

C. Despite its creation of such an iconic trope,

D. Ultimately limited in its lasting influence,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Albert Einstein's theory of general relativity allows for potential shortcuts through spacetime.
- These hypothetical spacetime tunnels are known as wormholes.
- For matter to travel through a wormhole, it would need to have negative energy density.
- Negative energy density means that the matter would have less energy than empty space.
- Such matter has not been shown to exist.

2

The student wants to acknowledge a complication affecting travel through wormholes. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. The hypothetical tunnels known as wormholes would be potential shortcuts through spacetime were it not for one complication: they have less energy than empty space.

B. Einstein's theory of general relativity allows for potential spacetime shortcuts called wormholes but does not explain how matter with negative energy density could travel through them.

C. For matter to travel through a wormhole, the matter would need to have less energy than empty space; such matter has not been shown to exist.

D. For wormholes to be possible, according to Einstein's theory of general relativity, they would have to allow for potential shortcuts through spacetime.

SATASHKENT

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Shanawdithit (1801-1829) was a Beothuk cartographer (mapmaker).
- Her maps of Newfoundland's Beothuk Lake outline both the lake and various points around the lake where encounters between the Indigenous Beothuk people and British colonists occurred.
- Her maps are notable for depicting the experiences the Beothuk had within the landscape.
- Contemporary Potawatomi cartographer Margaret Pearce: Indigenous cartography emphasizes "experienced space, or place," as opposed to the Western convention of depicting space as universal, homogenized, and devoid of human experience.

3

The student wants to describe Shanawdithit's approach and explain its significance. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Shanawdithit mapped Beothuk Lake through significant encounters that occurred there, an approach that Pearce describes as "depicting space as universal [and] homogenized."

B. By depicting experiences of the Beothuk that occurred around Beothuk Lake, Shanawdithit's maps reflect Indigenous cartography's emphasis on "experienced space, or place" rather than the landscape alone.

C. According to Pearce, Indigenous cartography, such as Shanawdithit's maps of Beothuk Lake, emphasizes "experienced space or place," which reflects the diversity of approaches that reflect the diversity of Indigenous cultures.

D. Shanawdithit's maps are part of a broader tradition of Indigenous cartography that, according to Pearce, ranges from "Hawaiian performative cartographies to Navajo verbal maps and sand paintings."

Many linguists have claimed that the lyricism of Alexander Pushkin's Russian novel in verse Eugene Onegin makes the work incapable of being faithfully translated, especially into English. The original work is written much like a long poem, featuring linguistic patterns and flourishes specific to the Russian language. Rather than striving to portray each scene of the novel literalIy, John Cranko, in his ballet adaptation of Eugene Onegin, opted to let the essence of the work's emotions inspire the passion of the dancers. Critic Emma Golden writes that Cranko's "choreography uses the poetry of the human body to summon the parts of Pushkin's novel that were deemed untranslatable-its commitments to rhythm, cadence, symmetry." It seems, then, that
.

4

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. English is a particularly difficult language into which to translate poetic works, as its rhythms differ from those of many other languages.

B. most critics believe that, like other English translations of Eugene Onegin, Cranko's ballet adaptation fails to capture the essence of the original's meaning.

C. Cranko's loose adaptation of Eugene Onegin into a different medium may have preserved fundamental elements of the source material better than a strictly literal written translation of the text would have.

D. though written works are frequently adapted into other formats, ballets are rarely considered to be faithful adaptations of texts.

Among saltwater fish species, there is a clear association between habitat latitude and morphological variety.
While tropical species are _____ deep-bodied physical forms (body shapes that are laterally compressed but vertically extended), polar and temperate species are highly dispersed across the morphological spectrum.

5

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. authenticated by

B. concentrated among

C. habituated to

D. contemporary with

Archaeologist Weiwei Wang and her colleagues analyzed footed grinding slabs and other food-preparation tools excavated from Óc Eo, a Southeast Asian port city that flourished between the first and sixth centuries CE. Wang and colleagues recovered microscopic remnants of turmeric and other spices from the surfaces of the tools. Turmeric is native to South Asia, more than a thousand miles west of Óc Eo, and the researchers showed that the footed grinding slabs at Óc Eo are very similar to footed grinding slabs common throughout South Asia from around 500 BCE to 300 CE. Wang and colleagues' findings therefore indicate that there must have been a trade link, whether direct or indirect, between the two regions.

6

Which finding, if true, would directly weaken the conclusion about Wang and her colleagues' findings that is presented in the text?

A. Other types of artifacts originating in South Asia and dating to the first through sixth centuries CE have been found throughout Southeast Asia.

B. In the first through third centuries CE, there was a significant migration of people from South Asia to Southeast Asia.

C. The people of Óc Eo and several communities in South Asia regularly traded with people in the region that is now the Southeast Asian country of Malaysia no later than the first century CE.

D. Some of the spices recovered from Óc Eo are native to the Maluku Islands, which are located approximately 2,000 miles southeast of Óc Eo.

$\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$	Age (Ma)
0.708980	6.20
0.709000	5.86
0.709020	5.40
0.709040	4.75
0.709060	3.00

The late Hemphillian (Hh) North American Land Mammal Age includes the subdivisions Hh3, 6.8 million years ago (Ma) to 6 Ma, and Hh4, 6 Ma to 4.75 Ma. While mammalian fossils have indicated that Florida's Montbrook Fossil Site (MFS) and Palmetto Fauna of the Bone Valley Region (PFBV) date to Hh4, a more precise determination of the sites' ages has proved challenging. Stephanie R. Killingsworth et al. compared average ratios of strontium-87 to strontium-86 ($\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$) in fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV-0.709000 and 0.709028, respectively-to $\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$ ratios in the global strontium seawater curve... The researchers concluded that .

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A. mammalian fossil evidence offers less dating precision than do $\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$ ratios in fossil shark teeth and that PFBV likely was deposited closer to the Hh3-Hh4 boundary than was MFS.

B. the average $\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$ ratios in the fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV resolve previous uncertainty about the sites' relative ages by indicating that both sites were deposited contemporaneously during the late Hh.

C. the average $\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$ ratios in the fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV only partially support the site age estimates previously established through mammalian fossil evidence.

D. the average $\frac{^{87}Sr}{^{86}Sr}$ ratios in the fossil shark teeth from MFS and PFBV corroborate that both MFS and PFBV fall within Hh4 but suggest that PFBV was likely deposited more recently than MFS.

Across brown bears-omnivores with high dietary plasticity-there is wide variety in dietary mix, which may reflect genetics, local resource availability, or social learning (cubs stay with their mothers for two years or more). Evaluating these possibilities, Anne Hertel et al. analyzed 30 years of data on trophic position (indicative of dietary mix) for female brown bears. After separation, daughters, who tended to settle near their mothers, occupied the same trophic positions as their mothers for two years, but the correlation disappeared by year five. Trophic correlation with unrelated individuals in similar habitats was modest, while habitat-independent correlation with nonmaternal relatives (e.g., cousins) was no different than with unrelated individuals. These findings suggest that _____.

8

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. social learning and resource fluctuations may both play a role in dietary mix among females, at least temporarily, though genetic factors appear to make a significant contribution as well.

B. dietary mix among females may reflect a social learning effect that eventually diminishes, though environmental constraints cannot be ruled out as a contributing factor.

C. female dietary mix is best understood as changeable and contingent on fluctuating environmental conditions rather than as the result of social learning or genetic factors.

D. growing dissimilarity between mothers and their daughters with regard to dietary mix may reflect changes in the resources available in maternal habitats, though social learning could also contribute to the trend.

Some farms are expanding their mix of crop species in an effort to reduce nonagricultural biodiversity loss caused by increasing agricultural specialization, in which farmers focus on a limited range of crops or livestock species to improve yields and, thus, their revenues. To study the joint environmental and economic effects of diversification practices, Laura Vang Rasmussen and team analyzed data from 2,655 farms in eleven countries. They found that using multiple diversification practices concurrently had greater potential for improving both nonagricultural biodiversity and yields than using a single strategy did. Their finding suggests that _____.

9

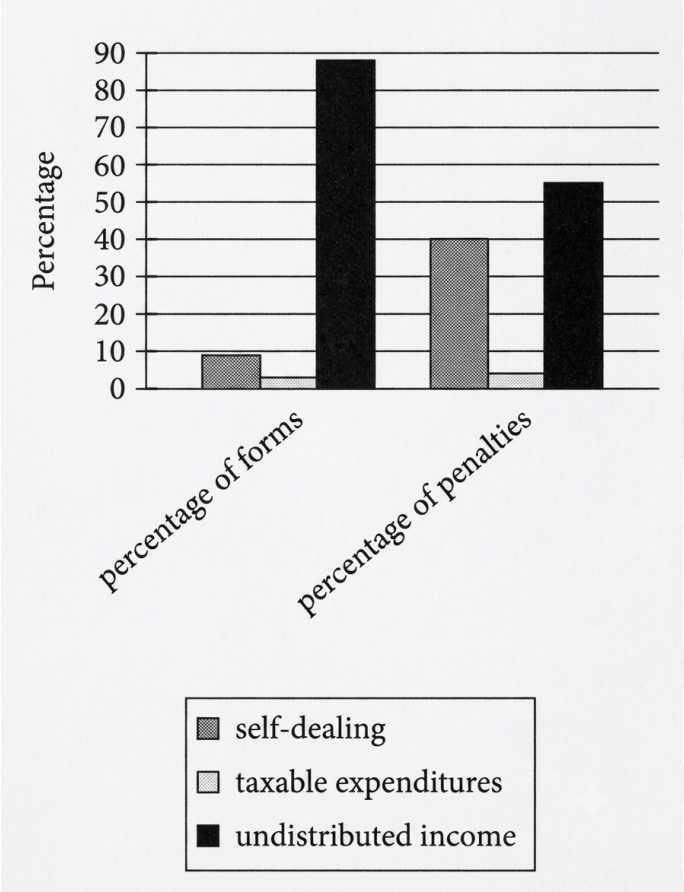
Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. farmers who focus primarily on increasing crop variety without engaging in other diversification practices will likely help reverse nonagricultural biodiversity loss, but their farms will produce smaller yields than if they had continued to focus on developing a single crop.

B. it is more expensive to increase crop variety while simultaneously implementing other diversification practices than it is to increase crop variety and then subsequently implement other diversification practices.

C. farmers who are reluctant to switch from specializing in a single crop to cultivating a variety of crops incorrectly assume that any improvements in yields will be insufficient to offset the costs associated with making that transition.

D. agricultural diversification doesn't inherently involve a trade-off between environmental and economic considerations, but farmers' chances of avoiding that outcome may be diminished if they focus on crop variety to the exclusion of other diversification practices.



While US public charities, like Kaiser Foundation Hospitals, must file Form 990 yearly with the IRS, private foundations, such as the David and Lucile Packard Foundation, must file a different form, 990-PF. In addition, foundations that engage in certain prohibited activities must also file Form 4720 and pay penalty taxes on the money involved. Prohibited activities for private foundations include "self-dealing" (conducting activities that benefit foundation insiders), making taxable expenditures such as outlays for lobbying, and failing to cross a required threshold in making charitable distributions from income.

The data in the graph best support which conclusion about organizations that filed Form 4720 in 2003?

A. Those that failed to meet the minimum charitable distribution requirement must have paid higher penalties, on average, than those organizations that filed Form 990 but also filed Form 4720 for the same reason did.

B. Those that engaged in self-dealing must have paid higher penalties, on average, than those that failed to meet the minimum charitable distribution requirement did.

C. Those that engaged in self-dealing and had taxable expenditures collectively paid a greater portion of the total penalty than those that failed to meet the minimum charitable distribution requirement did.

D. Those that failed to meet the minimum charitable distribution requirement filed a majority of the forms but did not pay a majority of the penalties.

. . . . . .

While many initiatives aimed at limiting atmospheric warming focus on curbing emissions of methane (CH_4), a greenhouse gas that is typically generated by microbially mediated processes, Lisa Y. Stein and Mary E. Lidstrom caution that under certain circumstances, such efforts cause microbial communities to accelerate production of nitrous oxide (N_2O), another potent greenhouse gas, thus offsetting the impact of CH_4 reduction. Researchers, therefore, need to take such biological interactions into account to ensure that any CH_4 mitigation strategy has an overall positive climate effect.

11

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It reports on a predicament resulting from emissions of a particular greenhouse gas, outlines a strategy aimed at solving that predicament, and then admonishes those who utilize that strategy without fully comprehending its ramifications.

B. It presents an ongoing environmental challenge, demonstrates why the impact of that challenge may intensify over time, and then criticizes a misguidedly narrow attempt to address that impact.

C. It mentions a phenomenon that negatively affects the environment, summarizes competing methods for remedying that phenomenon, and then concedes that even apparently distinct methods share similar problems.

D. It describes a widely accepted approach to addressing an environmental issue caused by a type of chemical emissions, indicates a potential disadvantage of that approach, and then discusses an implication of that disadvantage.

Hypothesizing that reliance on smartphones for information retrieval will lead a person to incorrectly remember instances of phone-assisted retrieval as instances of retrieval from memory, researchers asked participants general knowledge trivia questions, instructing them to answer certain questions using only their smartphone and other questions using only their memory. When surveyed a week later, participants exhibited higher levels of misattribution for answers retrieved in the smartphone condition than for those retrieved in the memory condition, a finding that the researchers claimed supported their hypothesis.

12

Which question would be most useful to answer in determining the validity of the researchers' claim as it is presented in the text?

A. How likely were participants to answer all the trivia questions correctly in both the smartphone and the memory conditions?

B. Were participants as likely to remember the source of their information when asked a week later as they would have been if asked immediately after answering the trivia questions?

C. Were participants less confident about the accuracy of information they were instructed to retrieve from a smartphone than they were of that retrieved from their own memory?

D. How did participants attribute information they were instructed to retrieve from a smartphone in instances when they already knew that information independently of their phone?

Southwestern Kentucky's Livingston County is among the most rural counties in the United States; the US Census Bureau classified it as 95.4% rural in 2010. Researchers often struggle to recruit residents of counties like Livingston for inclusion in studies. Melissa Valerio and colleagues tested whether an approach called snowball sampling improves recruitment. Working in two rural counties, they recruited a few people (known as "seeds") with the characteristics desired for a proposed study and asked them to recruit additional participants from their social networks. Though the seeds were given minimal guidance, many more people they recruited had the desired characteristics for the study than would be expected by chance alone, most likely because _____.

13

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. the characteristics that made the seeds desirable for inclusion in the proposed study may be unknown to some members of the seeds' social networks.

B. the seeds' social networks tend to be somewhat smaller than the networks of people who do not live in rural areas.

C. most seeds' social networks include some people who do not know one another and who share few characteristics.

D. the seeds' social networks include a high proportion of people who share characteristics with the seeds.

March 2026

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**B**	2	**C**
3	**B**	4	**C**
5	**B**	6	**B**
7	**D**	8	**A**
9	**D**	10	**B**
11	**D**	12	**D**
13	**D**		

May 2026

14 Questions

DIRECTIONS

A study by Peggy Liu and colleagues suggests that people underestimate the _____ they spark by unexpectedly reaching out to a social contact, particularly after a long period of no interaction. Not only are recipients of even simple gestures of affinity (e.g., a text message saying "hello") pleased by the gestures, that pleasure is largely commensurate with the recipients' degree of surprise.

1

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. incredulity

B. consternation

C. anticipation

D. gratification

In a 2020 investigation of factors influencing the abundance of the isotope U-238 in Xiligou Lake and three other lakes in northwest China, Zhao et al. therefore aimed to address the relative of scientific knowledge on uranium isotopes in inland bodies of water.

2

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A. aggregation

B. obsolescence

C. diminution

D. darth

A 2021 paper by Andrew Payne et al. introduced in situ genome sequencing (IGS), which allows simultaneous sequencing and imaging of genomes within biological samples and facilitates analysis of the relationship between a cell's DNA and structure. Integrating IGS with expansion microscopy, which uses polymers to enlarge small structures for imaging, a team led by Jason Buenrostro later developed expansion in situ genome sequencing (ExIGS) — a technique that also allows simultaneous sequencing and imaging of genomes, but without the limitations on spatial resolution inherent to IGS.

3

Which choice best describes the overall structure of the text?

A. It introduces an imaging technique that served as the precursor to a newer technique, describes how the older imaging technique was modified to create the newer technique, and then explains a key benefit of the newer technique.

B. It implies that an existing imaging technique for studying DNA samples has become obsolete, proposes that this technique be modified to incorporate elements of a different imaging technique, and then predicts the potential impact of the resulting hybrid technique.

C. It describes the role of an innovative technique that is used in studying DNA samples, notes that this technique can also be used in analysis of cellular structures, and then emphasizes this technique's superiority to conventional microscope imaging.

D. It explains the primary function of an older imaging technique, introduces a novel imaging technique that compensates for the original technique's limitations, and then reveals that the same researchers were responsible for developing both techniques.

Visiting flowers that produce high volumes of nectar allows hummingbirds, including long-billed hermits, to maximize their foraging efficiency. But nectar can't be seen from outside the flower, and while some studies have suggested that petal length may indicate nectar volume, María A. Maglianesi and team found no such association among hummingbird-visited plants at Los Cusingos Bird Sanctuary and other sites in Costa Rica. The researchers hypothesize that by driving hummingbirds to visit more plants in search of high-reward flowers, plants' lack of reliable signaling may increase chances of pollination.

4

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

A. It acknowledges research findings, which weren't replicated by the study discussed later in the text, positing a relationship between floral traits that potentially underlies hummingbird foraging decisions.

B. It summarizes contradictory study findings concerning a floral trait that influences hummingbird foraging patterns, which the study mentioned later in the text aimed to resolve.

C. It suggests that a hypothesis discussed later in the text regarding a potential visual cue that hummingbirds rely on to increase their foraging efficiency has little support from the broader scientific community.

D. It attributes the inconclusive findings reported in the text regarding the influence of a particular floral trait on interactions between hummingbirds and plants to differences in study sites.

A trend away from stable, relatively high humidity in the Middle East over the past 8 million years can be inferred from the composition of cave formations dating to different periods. Cave formations from about 7 million years ago mainly consist of transparent columnar calcite, indicative of an underground water system regularly replenished by rainfall. Cave formations younger than approximately 1 million years, however, mainly consist of branching, opaque (and sometimes colorful) material, often with more frequent growth interruptions, indicating an intermittent water supply.

5

Which choice best describes the function of the two underlined portions in the text as a whole?

A. They provide evidence from different Middle Eastern cave formations that substantiates the claim that the region experienced a long period of relatively high humidity.

B. They describe divergent features of cave formations that when taken together imply decreasing variation in Middle Eastern rainfall over time.

C. They draw a contrast between Middle Eastern cave formations that is suggestive of geographic differences in the underground water supply.

D. They identify different characteristics of cave formations that when considered together provide evidence for a long-term shift toward lower and more variable humidity in the Middle East.

The Bantu expansion refers to the gradual dispersal of Bantu-speaking peoples across much of sub-Saharan Africa over approximately 3,500 years, starting about 4,000 – 5,000 years ago (ya). Citing the discovery of pounding equipment dating as far back as 5,000 ya consistent with processing of plant foods, some researchers have asserted that the Bantu expansion can be explained by the farming/language dispersal hypothesis. This hypothesis proposes that the dispersal of many of the world's large language families was driven primarily by the adoption of agriculture.

6

Which finding, if true, would most directly challenge the assertion about the Bantu expansion presented in the text?

A. Among the earliest archaeobotanical evidence of plant farming in East Africa, which Bantu-speaking peoples may have reached as early as 3,500 ya, are traces of cowpea, a legume crop believed to have originated in West Africa.

B. Reconstructed vocabulary from Proto-Bantu contains terms for some wild plant species that early Bantu speakers actively managed and cultivated but that were never fully domesticated into true crop plants.

C. Lexical reconstructions indicate that the earliest Bantu speakers' words for yams were inherited from languages predating the arrival of Bantu ancestral groups in their homeland.

D. The earliest unambiguous archaeobotanical evidence of plant cultivation and domestication in West-Central Africa consists of pearl millet found in three sites in present-day Cameroon dated to around 2,200 – 2,350 ya.

King Henry is addressing noblemen who are rumored to have been disloyal.
KING HENRY: My blood hath been too cold and temperate,
Unapt to stir at these indignities,
And you have found me, for accordingly
You tread upon my patience; but be sure
I will from henceforth rather be myself,
Mighty and to be fear'd, than my disposition,
Which hath been smooth as oil, soft as young down...

7

Which statement best describes how King Henry presents himself in the text?

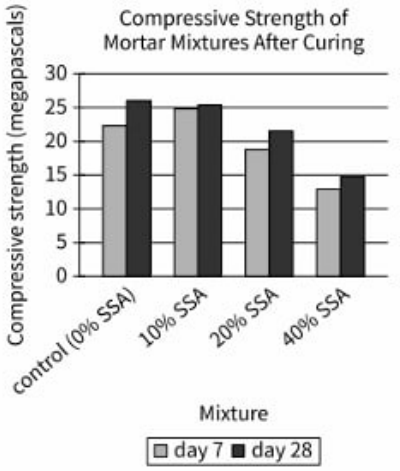
A. He defends his calm disposition and promises to maintain his tranquil demeanor even if it causes him to lose the respect of overly proud noblemen.

B. He concedes that he has treated the noblemen with indifference, but he asserts that their disrespectful behavior is primarily driven by their excessive pride.

C. He acknowledges to the noblemen that his tolerance of their conduct has diminished their respect for him, and he resolves to display his genuine nature, which is more forceful and compels deference.

D. He denies that he has been too lenient in the past, asserting instead that the noblemen misread his patience as weakness.

8



Mollusk shells are mainly composed of calcium carbonate, a chemical compound used in mortar and other construction materials. A research team led by Ariane da Silva Cardoso investigated pulverizing discarded Sururu mussel shells to create a substitute for fine aggregates (such as sand) in mortar mixtures. The team prepared mixtures with Sururu shell aggregate (SSA) replacing varying percentages of sand and then tested the mortars' compressive strength on days 7 and 28 of curing. Based on their findings, the team recommended SSA substitution in relatively small proportions to avoid compromising strength.

Which choice best describes the findings of the study based on the graph?

A. The compressive strength of the 10% SSA mixture never surpassed the compressive strength measured for the control mixture on day 28.

B. The compressive strength of the 10% SSA mixture remained nearly the same from day 7 to day 28, while that of the 20% and 40% SSA mixtures changed substantially.

C. The 10% SSA mixture's compressive strength was greater than or approximately equal to that of the control mixture on day 7 and on day 28, but on both days the 20% and 40% SSA mixtures had less compressive strength than the control mixture did.

D. The 10% SSA mixture's compressive strength was greater than that of the control mixture on day 7, but by day 28 the 10% SSA mixture's compressive strength had decreased while that of the control mixture had increased.

A 2025 study presents evidence that bonobos are capable of rudimentary compositionality—they can organize sounds such that the order carries meaning. Townsend's team claimed that bonobos sometimes paired calls in specific orders and that the contexts indicate they were deliberate communications.

9

Which finding, if true, would best support the researchers' claim?

A. A bonobo grunt seems to function as a request for other bonobos to join in whatever activity is ongoing.

B. While a single whistle from a bonobo was often an attempt to organize groups, a whistle preceded by a peep sound usually occurred in the presence of a charged social situation.

C. When bonobos paired grunts with other calls, they did not use rules of syntax as humans do.

D. Bonobos used a single yelp or a single peep as an imperative, but when these same calls were combined in reverse order, the meaning remained identical to the meaning of the calls when used singly.

Text 1: Fueling and other human activities are significant sources of atmospheric methane that are challenging to monitor. One promising approach is to use flux data from extant monitoring infrastructure as proxies for CH_4 fluxes in unmonitored areas.
Text 2: Malone et al. examined the United States network of towers and found that they are disproportionately concentrated in areas where biogenic CH_4 emissions are known to be elevated, a pattern that seriously compromises the representativeness of network data.

10

Based on the texts, Malone et al. (Text 2) would most likely agree with which statement about the "approach" described in Text 1?

A. It could compromise the accuracy of the biogenic CH_4 emissions data that EC towers collect in areas with elevated emissions.

B. It may suggest that biogenic CH_4 emissions in unmonitored areas are higher than they actually are.

C. It would only be viable if the EC towers monitoring biogenic CH_4 emissions could detect smaller fluxes than they can at present.

D. It is likely to be useful for determining biogenic CH_4 emissions in unmonitored areas of some regions but not of most regions.

The tudent wants to challenge the model used in Danielsdottir et al.'s study.
Notes:

- Danielsdottir et al.'s 2007 study of planktonic ecosystem used a nutrient-phytoplankton-zooplankton (NPZ) model.
- Diane Stoecker et al. (2017): NPZ models rely "on the differentiation of the planktonic communities into phytoplankton or zooplankton functional types," excluding mixotrophic plankton.
- Phytoplankton are exclusively phototrophic, producing nutrients via photosynthesis.
- Zooplankton are exclusively phagotrophic, obtaining nutrients by consuming other organisms.

11

Which choice most effectively uses data from the notes to complete the student's goal?

A. Since it classifies plankton as exclusively phototrophic producers or phagotrophic consumers, the model used in Danielsdottir et al.'s study may misrepresent planktonic ecosystems, in which—as Stoecker et al. note—many plankton combine these functions.

B. Danielsdottir et al.'s model disregards the respective roles of producers and consumers—organisms that, as Stoecker et al. emphasize, are essential to the trophic structure of the plankton food web.

C. By restricting plankton functional types to phytoplankton and zooplankton, the model used in Danielsdottir et al.'s study of planktonic ecosystems overlooks the many mixotrophic species that exist.

D. While NPZ models are standard in studies of planktonic ecosystems, they often ignore the complex ways that nutrients cycle through environments involving both phototrophic and phagotrophic species.

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Maltese lithic (stone implement) assemblages from the sixth and seventh millennia BCE exhibit notable characteristics. Nearly all implements were fashioned from limestone—mostly from beach cobbles—rather than superior chert or obsidian, and the assemblages predominantly comprise flakes produced through direct percussion, with negligible representation of cores, blades, or retouched tools. The fairly rudimentary nature of Malta's lithic industry parallels contemporaneous Sardinian technologies rather than the sophisticated geometric microlith traditions documented in neighboring Sicily.

12

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Maltese stone tools from the sixth and seventh millennia BCE are notable for their relative simplicity and their similarity with stone tools produced in Sicily.

B. While not definitive evidence, the materials and methods used in the production of Maltese stone tools in the sixth and seventh millennia BCE are strongly suggestive of the exchange of lithic technology between Malta, Sardinia, and Sicily.

C. The characteristics of Maltese stone tools from the sixth and seventh millennia BCE are indicative of a level of lithic technological development that, while not uniquely low, was less advanced than that observed nearby in Sicily.

D. Because limestone was more accessible to the ancient inhabitants of Malta than chert or obsidian, it was generally preferred for the manufacturing of simple stone implements throughout the sixth and seventh millennia BCE.

Here is an adaptation of established fiction genres to Southern contexts. Mark Twain derived his episodic narrative structures and roguish heroes from the picaresque novel, and William Faulkner realized the decadent aristocrat, the imperiled heroine, and other character types of the Gothic novel as rural Southerners who were more contingent, more caught in the net of societal relations and history than the fantastical figures of the Gothic had been. Some of the region's poets, such as James Dickey, have shown even greater dexterity by adapting these sources in an altogether different literary form.

13

Which statement, if true, would most directly support the underlined sentence?

A. With its rural settings and rustic characters, Dickey's poems suggest the influence of the genre of pastoral fiction, yet Dickey may have instead obtained these elements from pastoral poetry.

B. The Gothic genre emerged in England and Ireland in the 1700s and was later naturalized to the cultural landscape of the Northeastern US, as in the novels of Nathaniel Hawthorne.

C. "What is the disturbed, and disturbing, speaker of Dickey's best poems if not a stock character of the Gothic novel, refracted through the speech and ethos of the South and conditioned by the structures of lyric poetry?"

D. Faulkner and Dickey both utilized the historical landscape of the South to produce literature, albeit one focused on narrative prose while the other focused on concise verse expressions.

SATASHKENT

The Bantu expansion refers to the gradual dispersal of Bantu-speaking peoples across much of sub-Saharan Africa over approximately 3,500 years, starting about $4,000 - 5,000$ years ago (ya). Citing the discovery of pounding equipment dating as far back as 5,000 ya consistent with processing of plant foods, some researchers have asserted that the Bantu expansion can be explained by the farming/language dispersal hypothesis. This hypothesis proposes that the dispersal of many of the world's large language families—for instance, Sino-Tibetan—was driven primarily by the adoption of agriculture.

14

Which finding, if true, would most directly challenge the assertion about the Bantu expansion presented in the text?

A. Among the earliest archaeobotanical evidence of plant farming in East Africa, which Bantu-speaking peoples may have reached as early as 3,500 ya, are traces of cowpea, a legume crop believed to have originated in West Africa.

B. Reconstructed vocabulary from Proto-Bantu, the ancestral language from which all later Bantu languages descended, contains terms for some wild plant species that early Bantu speakers actively managed and cultivated.

C. Lexical reconstructions indicate that the earliest Bantu speakers' words for yams were inherited from languages predating the arrival of Bantu ancestral groups in their homeland.

D. The earliest unambiguous archaeobotanical evidence of plant cultivation and domestication in West-Central Africa consists of pearl millet found in three sites in present-day Cameroon dated to around $2,200 - 2,350$ ya and in one site in the DRC dated to around 2,200 ya.

SATASHKENT

May 2026

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**A**	2	**D**
3	**A**	4	**A**
5	**D**	6	**D**
7	**C**	8	**C**
9	**B**	10	**B**
11	**A**	12	**C**
13	**C**	14	**D**

June 2026

14 Questions

DIRECTIONS

Microhistories tackle "big questions" about broad phenomena via narrow subjects. The questions they ask are often _____. Distinct strains of microhistory emerged at different times in Italy, Iceland, and elsewhere, for example, and while microhistories of the 1980s reflected the era's interest in women's history, the "material turn" in recent historiography sparked a wave of object-centered microhistories.

1

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. contingent on the practitioner's milieu.

B. peripheral to the practitioner's discipline.

C. idiosyncratic to the practitioner's interests.

D. disconnected from the practitioner's training.

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The Exeter Book (ca. 960 – 990 CE) is the sole manuscript source for the entire corpus of Old English riddles. The precise number of riddles is a matter of debate. Identification of consecutive riddles boundaries based on content is difficult, given their purposely enigmatic nature, the challenges modern readers face in interpreting the archaic language of Old English, and damage to the manuscript. Moreover, the manuscript lacks any paratextual apparatus—titles, commentary, lists of solutions to delimit riddles, and the appearance of a distinctive mark to signal the ends of some riddles may be an unreliable clue. For instance, some scholars claim that the use of this mark at the end of the single manuscript line containing the text conventionally known as Riddle 68 may be a scribal error.

2

Given that the texts conventionally known as Riddle 65 and Riddle 69 appear consecutively in the manuscript, which evidence, if true, would most directly support the claim about Riddle 68 presented in the text?

A. Circumstantial evidence, including the fact that most of Riddles 63-72, which appear consecutively in the manuscript, repeat solutions from riddles scattered throughout earlier pages of the manuscript, suggests that Riddles 68 and 69 may have originated from a single source whose author was influenced by those earlier riddles.

B. Although Riddle 68 opens with a phrase in Old English meaning "I saw" that likewise appears at the beginning of a large number of the Exeter Book riddles, neither it nor Riddle 69 concludes with any phrases that directly invite the audience to solve the riddle, which nearly half of the Exeter Book riddles do.

C. Although Riddle 69 appears to be solvable when read on its own or in conjunction with Riddle 68, with "iceberg" or "icicle" having been presented as likely solutions, Riddle 68, whose imagery and sonic patterns are consistent with those of Riddle 69, has been deemed unsolvable given its overly generic clues, unless read in conjunction with Riddle 69.

D. Many of the Exeter Book riddles employ the rhetorical device of prosopopoeia, a form of personification in which a nonhuman entity, usually the solution to a riddle, is represented as speaking, but neither Riddle 68 nor Riddle 69 uses this device.

Animal fossils from the Arabian Peninsula come primarily from two time periods and locations: a late Miocene ($7.0 - 7.7$ million years ago) site in the Baynunah Formation and a Pleistocene ($12,000 - 500,000$ years ago) site in the Nefud Desert. The 6.5-million-year gap between these fossil assemblages occurs in the context of considerable evidence of concurrent African-Eurasian faunal exchange. While limited exchange may have occurred via island hopping across the 5.3-million-year-old Mediterranean Sea, many of the species that moved between the continents were adapted to grasslands that could not have existed in sufficient size on Mediterranean islands, leaving only the peninsula as a viable exchange route, a fact suggesting that

3

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A. conditions in the Arabian Peninsula were likely more conducive to fossilization before 7.7 million years ago and after 500,000 years ago than they were in the intervening period.

B. even though grasslands likely flourished on the Arabian Peninsula between 7.0 million years ago and 500,000 years ago, the peninsula was not the only route by which grassland-adapted animals traveled between Africa and Eurasia.

C. the absence of any evidence for African-Eurasian faunal exchange between 7.7 million years ago and 500,000 years ago should not be taken as evidence that the Arabian Peninsula formed a barrier to such exchange.

D. the gap in the fossil record between 7.0 million years ago and 500,000 years ago could be reflective of poor preservation conditions in the Arabian Peninsula at that time, inadequate fossil recovery efforts, or both.

Dziga Vertov's Man with a Movie Camera (1929) not only exhibits striking visual effects like multiple exposure, but it also has as a central idea that the camera itself is a character in the film. The camera's presence is continually accentuated by showing the operator position it, for example, placing it on the outside of a train, where he then adjusts the camera to capture a view of train tracks as seen from the front of a locomotive, to which the film cuts immediately after.

4

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

A. It introduces a conceit of the film that helps explain Vertov's choices as described later in the text.

B. It introduces a concept attributed to Vertov, which the remainder of the text affirms is rightly attributed.

C. It presents a metaphor that the text indicates inspired Vertov to structure the film as he did.

D. It presents Vertov's intended message for the film, which the remainder of the text uses as a basis to evaluate how successful the film was at conveying it.

Country	2020 Estimated electricity for green hydrogen production (kilowatts per capita)	2020 Percentage of direct-use electricity capacity	2050 Estimated electricity for green hydrogen production (kilowatts per capita)	2050 Percentage of direct-use electricity capacity
Indonesia	0.1	51%	0.1	63%
Malaysia	0.4	84%	1.0	82%
Taiwan	0.0	1%	0.5	17%
Turkey	0.1	17%	0.3	51%

In 2020, most hydrogen was produced through steam methane reforming, which emits carbon gases. Using electricity from renewable sources to produce green hydrogen sourced from water would enable countries to reduce industrial carbon emissions, but doing so depends on countries' capacity for direct-use electricity (electricity produced and used at the same facility). Researchers estimated the amount of electricity needed in 2020 if green hydrogen had been adopted and the amount needed to meet projected green hydrogen demand in 2050. Comparison between these estimates and estimates of capacity suggests that in most countries, projected green hydrogen production would require a larger share of electricity produced on-site. One exception is _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A. Malaysia, since the estimated electricity needed for green hydrogen production in 2050 is expected to be lower than it was in 2020.

B. Turkey, since the estimated electricity needed for green hydrogen production in 2050 is expected to be the same as it was in 2020.

C. Indonesia, since the estimated electricity needed for green hydrogen production in 2050 is expected to be the same as it was in 2020.

D. Taiwan, since the percentage of direct-use electricity needed to produce green hydrogen there in 2050 is the lowest of the countries listed.

The following text is from Richard B. Sheridan's 1777 satirical play The School for Scandal. Maria, Lady Sneerwell, and Joseph Surface are discussing their mutual acquaintance Sir Benjamin Backbite.

MARIA: [Sir Benjamin] has done nothing—but his conversation is a perpetual libel on all his acquaintance.

SURFACE: Aye and the worst of it is there is no advantage in not knowing him, for he'll abuse a stranger just as soon as his best friend—and [his uncle] is as bad.

SNEERWELL: Nay but we should make allowance. Sir Benjamin is a wit and a poet.

MARIA: For my part—I own madam—wit loses its respect with me, when I see it in company with malice. What do you think Mr. Surface?

SURFACE: Certainly, madam, to smile at the jest which plants a thorn on another's breast is to become a principal in the mischief.

6

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

A. It presents a position that seems to support the stance of one character and undermine that of another.

B. It contrasts the point of view of one character with that of another through the use of figurative language.

C. It illustrates and expands on one character's definition of a term that was discussed earlier in the text.

D. It appears to offer an explanation for the behavior of the character who is the topic of conversation in the text.

7

Projected Annual Costs and Profits of Biofuel Profit Models (in dollars)

Method	LCFS revenue	Total revenue	Total cost	Total profit
Heuristic	6,837,474	37,987,674	30,528,134	7,428,640
Lexicographic	9,878,474	40,998,474	30,528,134	10,470,340
Proposed	11,157,472	42,277,472	30,933,469	11,344,003

Biofuels typically emit less carbon than do fossil fuels. In California, biofuel manufacturers have two revenue sources: biofuel sales and LCFS (low carbon fuel standard) credits purchased from them by companies producing fuel that falls short of California's emission standards. Given the interplay between these revenue streams, Meltem Denizel et al. examined three models for how a biofuel firm might maximize profit: the industry-standard heuristic model, a lexicographic model, and a model proposed by the researchers. They concluded that although their model maximized profit, it might not be ideal for firms that need to minimize cash outflows.

Which choice best describes data from the table that support the researchers' conclusion?

A. While the proposed model projects the highest total profit, it also projects a higher total cost than the lexicographic model, which projects the same total cost as the heuristic model but a higher total profit.

B. Both the total revenue and total profit for the lexicographic model are higher than those for the heuristic model but lower than those for the proposed model.

C. While the total profit and the LCFS revenue are nearly the same for the proposed model, total profit is significantly greater than the LCFS revenue for the lexicographic model.

D. The proposed model shows the highest total revenue, LCFS revenue, and total cost of all three models.

The following text is adapted from George Eliot's 1860 novel The Mill on the Floss. After quarrelling with Tom Tulliver, Bob Jakin has just thrown his much cherished pocketknife, a gift from Tom, onto the ground in an attempt to spite Tom.

[Bob's] very fingers sent entreating thrills that he would go and clutch that familiar rough buck's-horn handle, which they had so often grasped for mere affection, as it lay idle in his pocket. And there were two blades, and they had just been sharpened! What is life without a pocket-knife to him who has once tasted a higher existence? No; to throw the handle after the hatchet is a comprehensible act of desperation, but to throw one's pocket-knife after an implacable friend is clearly in every sense a hyperbole, or throwing beyond the mark.

8

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined phrase in the text as a whole?

A. It suggests Bob's dawning realization that the importance he attaches to the pocketknife is excessive and absurd.

B. It alludes to Bob's unbridled propensity to invent wildly embellished tales of his own exploits.

C. It illustrates Bob's deliberate intention of using sophisticated vocabulary to intimidate Tom.

D. It conveys Bob's distinct awareness that spurning Tom's gift is an overly dramatic gesture.

Quantum entanglement, in which two particles seem to influence each other instantly even when separated by vast distances, appears to contradict classical physics, which holds that nothing can travel faster than light and that causality is unidirectional—causes precede effects. physicist Emily Adlam has argued that retrocausality—though also seemingly at odds with classical ideas—may help account for quantum entanglement without violating classical physics by allowing future and past states to be correlated within a fixed space-time.

9

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. By extension,

B. Essentially,

C. Predictably,

D. Paradoxically,

The scientific team using the Dark Energy Spectroscopic Instrument (DESI) to conduct a cosmological survey, which has generated the largest 3D map of our universe to date, plans to observe roughly 50 million celestial objects. Mounted on a telescope in Arizona,

10

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. the distribution of matter throughout our universe is tracked by researchers using this remarkable instrument that can measure 5,000 galaxies simultaneously.

B. researchers track how matter is distributed throughout our universe with this remarkable instrument that can measure 5,000 galaxies simultaneously.

C. 5,000 galaxies can be measured simultaneously by this remarkable instrument, tracking how matter is distributed throughout our universe.

D. this remarkable instrument can measure 5,000 galaxies simultaneously, tracking how matter is distributed throughout our universe.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Canteen Co-op is a democratically run convenience store based in Hong Kong.
- 1914: Webb and Webb's degeneration thesis argued that democratic workplaces will either fail or be forced to adopt hierarchical governance to remain profitable.
- 2012: Diamantopoulos's regeneration thesis argued that workplaces could regenerate (recover from degeneration by reintroducing democratic practices).
- 2022: Unterrainer et al. analyzed data from 73 democratic workplaces to track structural changes over time.
- Canteen Co-op was among the 52.7% of the studied workplaces that resisted degeneration.
- 10.8% of the workplaces had regenerated, 27.0% showed partial signs of degeneration, and 9.5% had fully degenerated and never recovered.

11

The student wants to use data to support Diamantopoulos's thesis. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A. Signs of degeneration were seen in 27.0% of democratic workplaces studied, supporting Diamantopoulos's assertion that degeneration could be reversed.

B. An impressive 52.7% of democratic workplaces studied—including Canteen Co-op—resisted degeneration, lending credence to Diamantopoulos's regeneration thesis.

C. Though Webb and Webb's degeneration thesis insisted on the inevitability of such an outcome, only 9.5% of democratic workplaces studied had fully degenerated and never recovered.

D. Around 10.8% of democratic workplaces in the study successfully used democratic practices to recover from degeneration.

The widespread use of mathematical scoring systems in combat sports reflects a Western-influenced preference for quantifiable competitions. _____ the scoring system in traditional Muay Thai (Thai boxing) treats fights as unfolding narratives in which the significance of any given exchange is inextricable from the broader arc of the contest—the winner being determined not by a numerical tally of discrete actions but by an overall assessment of the fighters' performances.

12

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A. In marked contrast to this approach,

B. Due in part to this cultural preference,

C. Constructed with a similar intent,

D. As another example of this methodology,

_____ historical economic data is pivotal to understanding the effects of various economic policies. These long-term records allow researchers to compare a nation's economic conditions prior to a policy's introduction with conditions that emerge years after implementation.

13

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A. A researcher's access to nation's

B. researchers access to nations'

C. researchers access to nations

D. researchers' access to nations'

SATASHKENT

Number of Days to Construct Modular Retail Facilities

Retail facilities	Construction company	Days to complete	Location
Constitutional Hill Coffee Shop	Modular Site Solutions	23	Johannesburg, South Africa
Nine Sales Centre	Giant Containers	120	Ontario, Canada
Carter Credit Union	Black Diamond Group & ProMod	350	Louisiana, USA
St. Regis Residences - Rye	Cassone Leasing	443	New York, USA

The rapid completion of the Hermeus Office and Engine Testing Center, a modular structure (a structure built in pieces elsewhere and assembled on site) located in the United States, led an employee at another company to collect data on other facilities built using modular construction methods. The employee concluded that modular construction is more efficient than other construction methods.

Based on the text and the table, is the employee's conclusion supported?

A. No, because the data in the table show that modular construction projects vary considerably in their number of construction days.

B. No, because not enough information has been provided to allow a comparison of different construction methods' efficiency.

C. Yes, because the Constitutional Hill Coffee Shop was completed in only 23 days.

D. Yes, because even the project with the longest construction time shown in the table was completed more quickly than it would have been if a different method had been used.

June 2025

Answer Key

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	**A**	2	**C**
3	**D**	4	**A**
5	**C**	6	**A**
7	**A**	8	**D**
9	**D**	10	**D**
11	**D**	12	**A**
13	**D**	14	**B**

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Every question in this book has been carefully selected, entered, and reviewed to ensure accuracy and exam-level quality.